

Functions and Sequences

1

Often a graph is the best way to represent a function because it conveys so much information at a glance. The electrocardiograms shown are graphs that exhibit electrical activity in various parts of the heart (See Figure 1 on page 2.) They enable a cardiologist to view the heart from different angles and thereby diagnose possible problems.

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1.1 Four Ways to Represent a Function

1.2 A Catalog of Essential Functions

1.3 New Functions from Old Functions

PROJECT: The Biomechanics of Human Movement

1.4 Exponential Functions

1.5 Logarithms; Semilog and Log-Log Plots

PROJECT: The Coding Function of DNA

1.6 Sequences and Difference Equations

PROJECT: Drug Resistance in Malaria

CASE STUDY 1a: Kill Curves and Antibiotic Effectiveness

THE FUNDAMENTAL OBJECTS THAT WE deal with in calculus are functions. This chapter prepares the way for calculus by discussing the basic ideas concerning functions, their graphs, and ways of transforming and combining them. We stress that a function can be represented in different ways: by an equation, in a table, by a graph, or in words. We look at the main types of functions that occur in calculus and describe the process of using these functions as mathematical models in biology. A special type of function, namely a sequence, is often used in modeling biological phenomena. In particular, we study recursive sequences, also called difference equations, because they are useful in describing cell division, insect populations, and other biological processes.

1.1 Four Ways to Represent a Function

Functions arise whenever one quantity depends on another. Consider the following four situations.

Table 1

Year	Population (millions)
1900	1650
1910	1750
1920	1860
1930	2070
1940	2300
1950	2560
1960	3040
1970	3710
1980	4450
1990	5280
2000	6080
2010	6870

- A. The area A of a circle depends on the radius r of the circle. The rule that connects r and A is given by the equation $A = \pi r^2$. With each positive number r there is associated one value of A , and we say that A is a *function* of r .
- B. The human population of the world P depends on the time t . Table 1 gives estimates of the world population $P(t)$ at time t , for certain years. For instance,

$$P(1950) \approx 2,560,000,000$$

But for each value of the time t there is a corresponding value of P , and we say that P is a function of t .

- C. The cost C of mailing an envelope depends on its weight w . Although there is no simple formula that connects w and C , the post office has a rule for determining C when w is known.
- D. Figure 1 shows a graph called an electrocardiogram (ECG), or rhythm strip, one of 12 produced by an electrocardiograph. It measures the electric potential V (measured in millivolts) as a function of time in a certain direction (toward the positive electrode of a lead) corresponding to a particular part of the heart. For a given value of the time t , the graph provides a corresponding value of V .

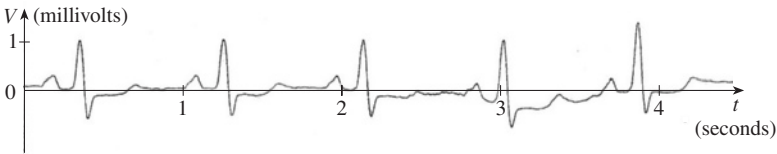


FIGURE 1
Electrocardiogram
Source: Courtesy of Dr. Brian Gilbert

Each of these examples describes a rule whereby, given a number (r , t , w , or t), another number (A , P , C , or V) is assigned. In each case we say that the second number is a function of the first number.

Definition A **function** f is a rule that assigns to each element x in a set D exactly one element, called $f(x)$, in a set E .

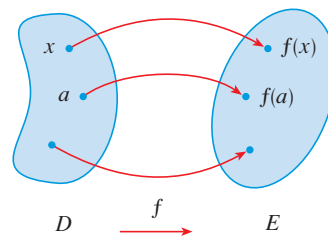
**FIGURE 2**Machine diagram for a function f

We usually consider functions for which the sets D and E are sets of real numbers. The set D is called the **domain** of the function. The number $f(x)$ is the **value of f at x** and is read “ f of x .” The **range** of f is the set of all possible values of $f(x)$ as x varies throughout the domain. A symbol that represents an arbitrary number in the *domain* of a function f is called an **independent variable**. A symbol that represents a number in the *range* of f is called a **dependent variable**. In Example A, for instance, r is the independent variable and A is the dependent variable.

It’s helpful to think of a function as a **machine** (see Figure 2). If x is in the domain of the function f , then when x enters the machine, it’s accepted as an input and the machine produces an output $f(x)$ according to the rule of the function. Thus we can think of the domain as the set of all possible inputs and the range as the set of all possible outputs.

The preprogrammed functions in a calculator are good examples of a function as a machine. For example, the square root key on your calculator computes such a function. You press the key labeled $\sqrt{}$ (or $\sqrt{x}$) and enter the input x . If $x < 0$, then x is not in the domain of this function; that is, x is not an acceptable input, and the calculator will indicate an error. If $x \geq 0$, then an *approximation* to $\sqrt{x}$ will appear in the display. Thus the $\sqrt{x}$ key on your calculator is not quite the same as the exact mathematical function f defined by $f(x) = \sqrt{x}$.

Another way to picture a function is by an **arrow diagram** as in Figure 3. Each arrow connects an element of D to an element of E . The arrow indicates that $f(x)$ is associated with x , $f(a)$ is associated with a , and so on.

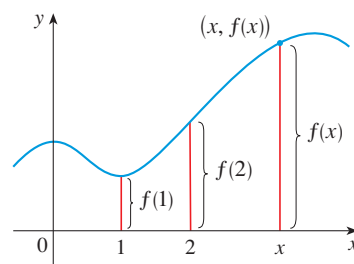
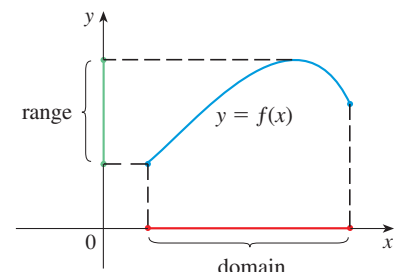
**FIGURE 3**Arrow diagram for f

The most common method for visualizing a function is its graph. If f is a function with domain D , then its **graph** is the set of ordered pairs

$$\{(x, f(x)) \mid x \in D\}$$

(Notice that these are input-output pairs.) In other words, the graph of f consists of all points (x, y) in the coordinate plane such that $y = f(x)$ and x is in the domain of f .

The graph of a function f gives us a useful picture of the behavior of a function. Since the y -coordinate of any point (x, y) on the graph is $y = f(x)$, we can read the value of $f(x)$ from the graph as being the height of the graph above the point x (see Figure 4). The graph of f also allows us to picture the domain of f on the x -axis and its range on the y -axis as in Figure 5.

**FIGURE 4****FIGURE 5**

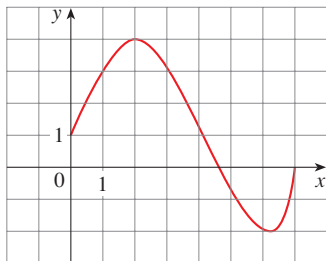


FIGURE 6

The notation for intervals is given in Appendix A.

EXAMPLE 1 | The graph of a function f is shown in Figure 6.

- (a) Find the values of $f(1)$ and $f(5)$.
 (b) What are the domain and range of f ?

SOLUTION

(a) We see from Figure 6 that the point $(1, 3)$ lies on the graph of f , so the value of f at 1 is $f(1) = 3$. (In other words, the point on the graph that lies above $x = 1$ is 3 units above the x -axis.)

When $x = 5$, the graph lies about 0.7 units below the x -axis, so we estimate that $f(5) \approx -0.7$.

(b) We see that $f(x)$ is defined when $0 \leq x \leq 7$, so the domain of f is the closed interval $[0, 7]$. Notice that f takes on all values from -2 to 4 , so the range of f is

$$\{y \mid -2 \leq y \leq 4\} = [-2, 4]$$

EXAMPLE 2 | Sketch the graph and find the domain and range of each function.

- (a) $f(x) = 2x - 1$ (b) $g(x) = x^2$

SOLUTION

(a) The equation of the graph is $y = 2x - 1$, and we recognize this as being the equation of a line with slope 2 and y -intercept -1 . (Recall the slope-intercept form of the equation of a line: $y = mx + b$. See Appendix B.) This enables us to sketch a portion of the graph of f in Figure 7. The expression $2x - 1$ is defined for all real numbers, so the domain of f is the set of all real numbers, which we denote by $\mathbb{R}$. The graph shows that the range is also $\mathbb{R}$.

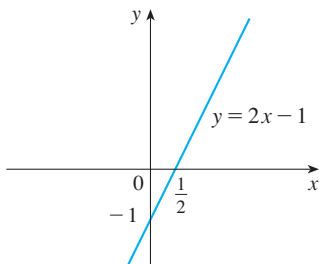


FIGURE 7

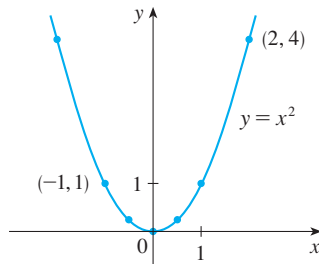


FIGURE 8

(b) Since $g(2) = 2^2 = 4$ and $g(-1) = (-1)^2 = 1$, we could plot the points $(2, 4)$ and $(-1, 1)$, together with a few other points on the graph, and join them to produce the graph (Figure 8). The equation of the graph is $y = x^2$, which represents a parabola (see Appendix B). The domain of g is $\mathbb{R}$. The range of g consists of all values of $g(x)$, that is, all numbers of the form x^2 . But $x^2 \geq 0$ for all numbers x and any positive number y is a square. So the range of g is $\{y \mid y \geq 0\} = [0, \infty)$. This can also be seen from Figure 8. ■

EXAMPLE 3 | Antihypertension medication Figure 9 shows the effect of nifedipine tablets (antihypertension medication) on the heart rate $H(t)$ of a patient as a function of time.

- (a) Estimate the heart rate after two hours.
 (b) During what time period is the heart rate less than 65 beats/min?

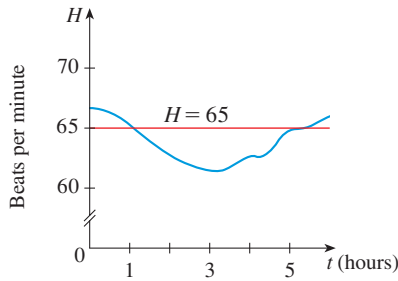


FIGURE 9

Source: Adapted from M. Brown et al., “Formulation of Long-Acting Nifedipine Tablets Influences the Heart Rate and Sympathetic Nervous System Response in Hypertensive Patients,” *British Journal of Clinical Pharmacology* 65 (2008): 646–52.

SOLUTION

(a) If $H(t)$ is the rate at time t , we estimate from the graph in Figure 9 that

$$H(2) \approx 62.5 \text{ beats/min}$$

(b) Notice that the curve lies below the line $H = 65$ for $1 \leq t \leq 5$. In other words, the heart rate is less than 65 beats/min from 1 hour to 5 hours after the tablet is administered.

EXAMPLE 4 | If $f(x) = 2x^2 - 5x + 1$ and $h \neq 0$, evaluate $\frac{f(a+h) - f(a)}{h}$.

SOLUTION We first evaluate $f(a+h)$ by replacing x by $a+h$ in the expression for $f(x)$:

$$\begin{aligned} f(a+h) &= 2(a+h)^2 - 5(a+h) + 1 \\ &= 2(a^2 + 2ah + h^2) - 5(a+h) + 1 \\ &= 2a^2 + 4ah + 2h^2 - 5a - 5h + 1 \end{aligned}$$

Then we substitute into the given expression and simplify:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{f(a+h) - f(a)}{h} &= \frac{(2a^2 + 4ah + 2h^2 - 5a - 5h + 1) - (2a^2 - 5a + 1)}{h} \\ &= \frac{2a^2 + 4ah + 2h^2 - 5a - 5h + 1 - 2a^2 + 5a - 1}{h} \\ &= \frac{4ah + 2h^2 - 5h}{h} = 4a + 2h - 5 \end{aligned}$$

The expression

$$\frac{f(a+h) - f(a)}{h}$$

in Example 4 is called a **difference quotient** and occurs frequently in calculus. As we will see in Chapter 2, it represents the average rate of change of $f(x)$ between $x = a$ and $x = a + h$.

■ Representations of Functions

There are four possible ways to represent a function:

- verbally (by a description in words)
- numerically (by a table of values)
- visually (by a graph)
- algebraically (by an explicit formula)

If a single function can be represented in all four ways, it's often useful to go from one representation to another to gain additional insight into the function. (In Example 2, for instance, we started with algebraic formulas and then obtained the graphs.) But certain functions are described more naturally by one method than by another. With this in mind, let's reexamine the four situations that we considered at the beginning of this section.

A. The most useful representation of the area of a circle as a function of its radius is probably the algebraic formula $A(r) = \pi r^2$, though it is possible to compile a table of values or to sketch a graph (half a parabola). Because a circle has to have a positive radius, the domain is $\{r \mid r > 0\} = (0, \infty)$, and the range is also $(0, \infty)$.

t (years since 1990)	Population (millions)
0	1650
10	1750
20	1860
30	2070
40	2300
50	2560
60	3040
70	3710
80	4450
90	5280
100	6080
110	6870

B. We are given a description of the function in words: $P(t)$ is the human population of the world at time t . Let's measure t so that $t = 0$ corresponds to the year 1900. The table of values of world population provides a convenient representation of this function. If we plot these values, we get the graph (called a *scatter plot*) in Figure 10. It too is a useful representation; the graph allows us to absorb all the data at once. What about a formula? Of course, it's impossible to devise an explicit formula that gives the exact human population $P(t)$ at any time t . But it is possible to find an expression for a function that *approximates* $P(t)$. In fact, using methods explained in Section 1.2, we obtain the approximation

$$P(t) \approx f(t) = (1.43653 \times 10^9) \cdot (1.01395)^t$$

Figure 11 shows that it is a reasonably good “fit.” The function f is called a *mathematical model* for population growth. In other words, it is a function with an explicit formula that approximates the behavior of our given function. We will see, however, that the ideas of calculus can be applied to a table of values; an explicit formula is not necessary.

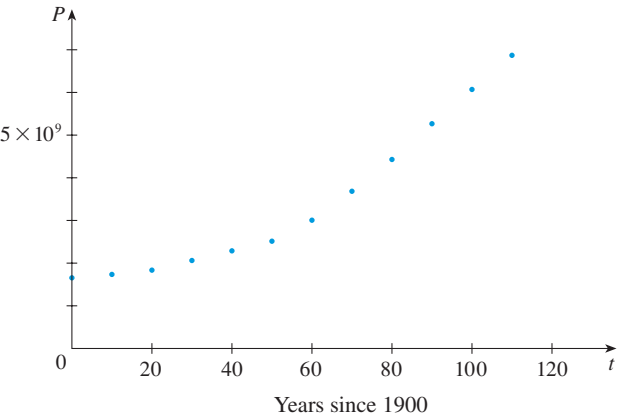


FIGURE 10

A function defined by a table of values is called a *tabular* function.

w (ounces)	$C(w)$ (dollars)
$0 < w \leq 1$	0.92
$1 < w \leq 2$	1.12
$2 < w \leq 3$	1.32
$3 < w \leq 4$	1.52
$4 < w \leq 5$	1.72
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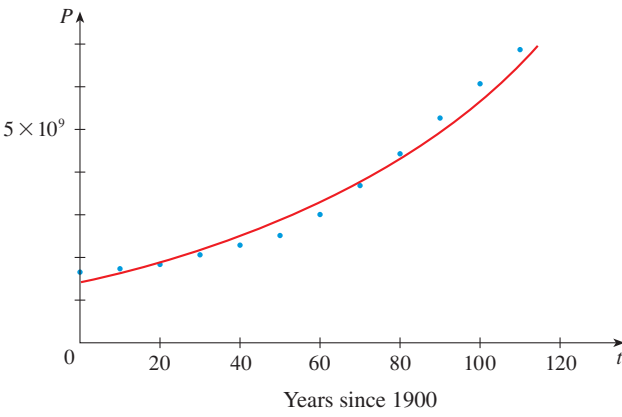


FIGURE 11

The function P is typical of the functions that arise whenever we attempt to apply calculus to the real world. We start with a verbal description of a function. Then we might be able to construct a table of values of the function, perhaps from instrument readings in a scientific experiment. Even though we don't have complete knowledge of the values of the function, we will see throughout the book that it is still possible to perform the operations of calculus on such a function.

- C. Again the function is described in words: Let $C(w)$ be the cost of mailing a large envelope with weight w . The rule that the US Postal Service used as of 2014 is as follows: The cost is 92 cents for up to 1 oz, plus 20 cents for each additional ounce (or less) up to 13 oz. The table of values shown in the margin is the most convenient representation for this function, though it is possible to sketch a graph (see Example 11).
- D. The graph shown in Figure 1 is the most natural representation of the voltage function $V(t)$ that reflects the electrical activity of the heart. It's true that a table of values could be compiled, and it is even possible to devise an approximate formula. But everything a doctor needs to know—amplitudes and patterns—can be seen easily from the graph. (The same is true for the patterns seen in polygraphs for lie-detection and seismographs for analysis of earthquakes.) The waves represent

the depolarization and repolarization of the atria and ventricles of the heart. They enable a cardiologist to see whether the patient has irregular heart rhythms and help diagnose different types of heart disease.

In the next example we sketch the graph of a function that is defined verbally.

EXAMPLE 5 | When you turn on a hot-water faucet, the temperature T of the water depends on how long the water has been running. Draw a rough graph of T as a function of the time t that has elapsed since the faucet was turned on.

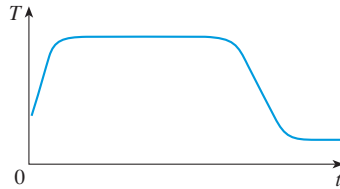


FIGURE 12

SOLUTION The initial temperature of the running water is close to room temperature because the water has been sitting in the pipes. When the water from the hot-water tank starts flowing from the faucet, T increases quickly. In the next phase, T is constant at the temperature of the heated water in the tank. When the tank is drained, T decreases to the temperature of the water supply. This enables us to make the rough sketch of T as a function of t in Figure 12.

EXAMPLE 6 | **BB** Bone mass A human femur (thighbone) is essentially a hollow tube filled with yellow marrow (see Figure 13). If the outer radius is r and the inner radius is r_{in} , an important quantity characterizing such bones is

$$k = \frac{r_{\text{in}}}{r}$$

The density of bone is approximately 1.8 g/cm^3 and that of marrow is about 1 g/cm^3 . For a femur with length L , express its mass as a function of k .

SOLUTION The mass of the tubular bone is obtained by subtracting the mass of the inner tube from the mass of the outer tube:

$$1.8\pi r^2 L - 1.8\pi r_{\text{in}}^2 L = 1.8\pi r^2 L - 1.8\pi (rk)^2 L$$

Similarly, the mass of the marrow is

$$1 \times (\pi r_{\text{in}}^2 L) = \pi (rk)^2 L$$

So the total mass as a function of k is

$$\begin{aligned} m(k) &= 1.8\pi r^2 L - 1.8\pi (rk)^2 L + \pi (rk)^2 L \\ &= \pi r^2 L (1.8 - 0.8k^2) \end{aligned}$$

EXAMPLE 7 | Find the domain of each function.

(a) $f(x) = \sqrt{x+2}$

(b) $g(x) = \frac{1}{x^2 - x}$

SOLUTION

(a) Because the square root of a negative number is not defined (as a real number), the domain of f consists of all values of x such that $x+2 \geq 0$. This is equivalent to $x \geq -2$, so the domain is the interval $[-2, \infty)$.

(b) Since

$$g(x) = \frac{1}{x^2 - x} = \frac{1}{x(x-1)}$$

and division by 0 is not allowed, we see that $g(x)$ is not defined when $x = 0$ or $x = 1$.

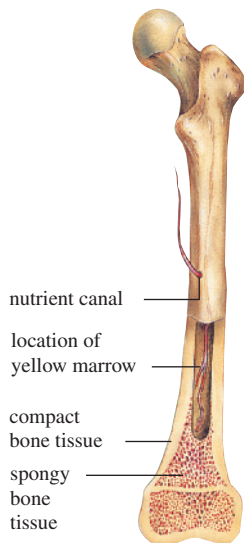


FIGURE 13

Structure of a human femur

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Domain Convention

If a function is given by a formula and the domain is not stated explicitly, the convention is that the domain is the set of all numbers for which the formula makes sense and defines a real number.

Thus the domain of g is

$$\{x \mid x \neq 0, x \neq 1\}$$

which could also be written in interval notation as

$$(-\infty, 0) \cup (0, 1) \cup (1, \infty)$$

The graph of a function is a curve in the xy -plane. But the question arises: Which curves in the xy -plane are graphs of functions? This is answered by the following test.

The Vertical Line Test A curve in the xy -plane is the graph of a function of x if and only if no vertical line intersects the curve more than once.

The reason for the truth of the Vertical Line Test can be seen in Figure 14. If each vertical line $x = a$ intersects a curve only once, at (a, b) , then exactly one function value is defined by $f(a) = b$. But if a line $x = a$ intersects the curve twice, at (a, b) and (a, c) , then the curve can't represent a function because a function can't assign two different values to a .

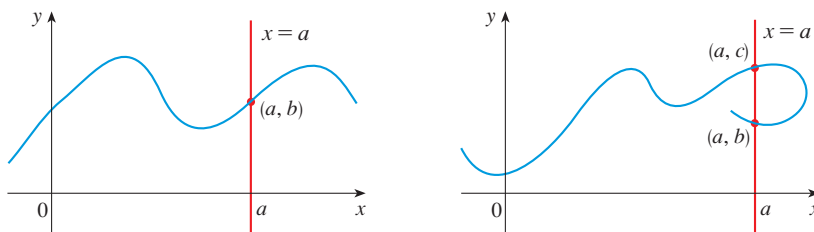


FIGURE 14

For example, the parabola $x = y^2 - 2$ shown in Figure 15(a) is not the graph of a function of x because, as you can see, there are vertical lines that intersect the parabola twice. The parabola, however, does contain the graphs of *two* functions of x . Notice that the equation $x = y^2 - 2$ implies $y^2 = x + 2$, so $y = \pm\sqrt{x + 2}$. Thus the upper and lower halves of the parabola are the graphs of the functions $f(x) = \sqrt{x + 2}$ [from Example 7(a)] and $g(x) = -\sqrt{x + 2}$. [See Figures 15(b) and (c).] We observe that if we reverse the roles of x and y , then the equation $x = h(y) = y^2 - 2$ *does* define x as a function of y (with y as the independent variable and x as the dependent variable) and the parabola now appears as the graph of the function h .

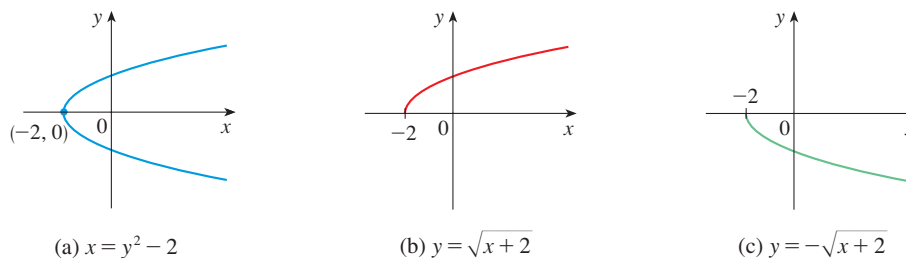


FIGURE 15

■ Piecewise Defined Functions

The functions in the following four examples are defined by different formulas in different parts of their domains. Such functions are called **piecewise defined functions**.

EXAMPLE 8 | A function f is defined by

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} 1 - x & \text{if } x \leq -1 \\ x^2 & \text{if } x > -1 \end{cases}$$

Evaluate $f(-2)$, $f(-1)$, and $f(0)$ and sketch the graph.

SOLUTION Remember that a function is a rule. For this particular function the rule is the following: First look at the value of the input x . If it happens that $x \leq -1$, then the value of $f(x)$ is $1 - x$. On the other hand, if $x > -1$, then the value of $f(x)$ is x^2 .

$$\text{Since } -2 \leq -1, \text{ we have } f(-2) = 1 - (-2) = 3.$$

$$\text{Since } -1 \leq -1, \text{ we have } f(-1) = 1 - (-1) = 2.$$

$$\text{Since } 0 > -1, \text{ we have } f(0) = 0^2 = 0.$$

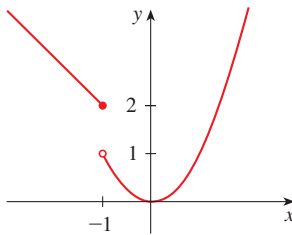


FIGURE 16

How do we draw the graph of f ? We observe that if $x \leq -1$, then $f(x) = 1 - x$, so the part of the graph of f that lies to the left of the vertical line $x = -1$ must coincide with the line $y = 1 - x$, which has slope -1 and y -intercept 1 . If $x > -1$, then $f(x) = x^2$, so the part of the graph of f that lies to the right of the line $x = -1$ must coincide with the graph of $y = x^2$, which is a parabola. This enables us to sketch the graph in Figure 16. The solid dot indicates that the point $(-1, 2)$ is included on the graph; the open dot indicates that the point $(-1, 1)$ is excluded from the graph. ■

The next example of a piecewise defined function is the absolute value function. Recall that the **absolute value** of a number a , denoted by $|a|$, is the distance from a to 0 on the real number line. Distances are always positive or 0 , so we have

$$|a| \geq 0 \quad \text{for every number } a$$

For example,

$$|3| = 3 \quad |-3| = 3 \quad |0| = 0 \quad |\sqrt{2} - 1| = \sqrt{2} - 1 \quad |3 - \pi| = \pi - 3$$

In general, we have

$$\begin{cases} |a| = a & \text{if } a \geq 0 \\ |a| = -a & \text{if } a < 0 \end{cases}$$

(Remember that if a is negative, then $-a$ is positive.)

EXAMPLE 9 | Sketch the graph of the absolute value function $f(x) = |x|$.

SOLUTION From the preceding discussion we know that

$$|x| = \begin{cases} x & \text{if } x \geq 0 \\ -x & \text{if } x < 0 \end{cases}$$

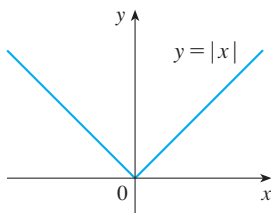


FIGURE 17

Using the same method as in Example 8, we see that the graph of f coincides with the line $y = x$ to the right of the y -axis and coincides with the line $y = -x$ to the left of the y -axis (see Figure 17). ■

EXAMPLE 10 | **BB** **Metabolic power in walking and running** Suppose you are walking slowly but then increase your pace and start running more and more quickly to catch a bus. When you start running, your gait (manner of movement) changes. Figure 18 shows a graph of metabolic power consumed by men walking and running (calculated from measurements of oxygen consumption) as a function of speed. Notice that it is a piecewise defined function and the second piece starts when you begin to run.

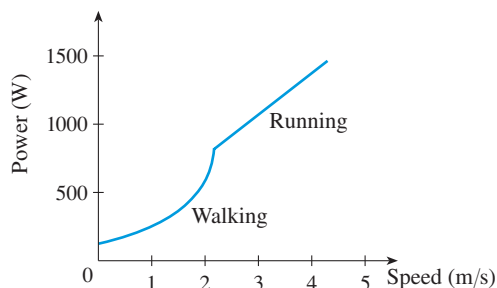


FIGURE 18

Metabolic power is a piecewise defined function of speed

Source: Adapted from R. Alexander, *Optima for Animals*, 2nd ed. (Princeton, NJ: Princeton University Press, 1996), 53.

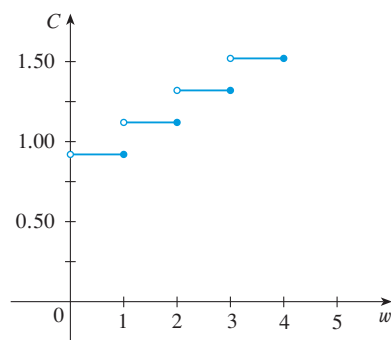


FIGURE 19

EXAMPLE 11 | In Example C at the beginning of this section we considered the cost $C(w)$ of mailing a large envelope with weight w . In effect, this is a piecewise defined function because, from the table of values on page 6, we have

$$C(w) = \begin{cases} 0.92 & \text{if } 0 < w \leq 1 \\ 1.12 & \text{if } 1 < w \leq 2 \\ 1.32 & \text{if } 2 < w \leq 3 \\ 1.52 & \text{if } 3 < w \leq 4 \\ \vdots & \end{cases}$$

The graph is shown in Figure 19. You can see why functions similar to this one are called **step functions**—they jump from one value to the next. Such functions will be studied in Chapter 2.

Symmetry

If a function f satisfies $f(-x) = f(x)$ for every number x in its domain, then f is called an **even function**. For instance, the function $f(x) = x^2$ is even because

$$f(-x) = (-x)^2 = x^2 = f(x)$$

The geometric significance of an even function is that its graph is symmetric with respect to the y -axis (see Figure 20). This means that if we have plotted the graph of f for $x \geq 0$, we obtain the entire graph simply by reflecting this portion about the y -axis.

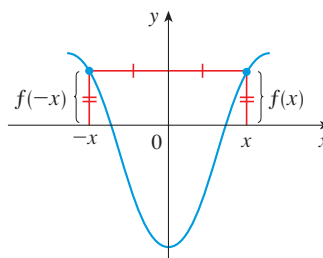


FIGURE 20

An even function

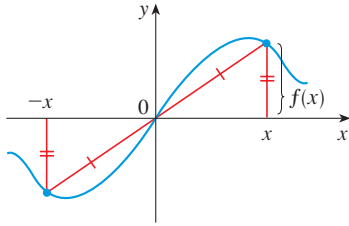


FIGURE 21
An odd function

If f satisfies $f(-x) = -f(x)$ for every number x in its domain, then f is called an **odd function**. For example, the function $f(x) = x^3$ is odd because

$$f(-x) = (-x)^3 = -x^3 = -f(x)$$

The graph of an odd function is symmetric about the origin (see Figure 21). If we already have the graph of f for $x \geq 0$, we can obtain the entire graph by rotating this portion through 180° about the origin.

EXAMPLE 12 | Determine whether each of the following functions is even, odd, or neither even nor odd.

- (a) $f(x) = x^5 + x$ (b) $g(x) = 1 - x^4$ (c) $h(x) = 2x - x^2$

SOLUTION

$$\begin{aligned} \text{(a)} \quad f(-x) &= (-x)^5 + (-x) = (-1)^5 x^5 + (-x) \\ &= -x^5 - x = -(x^5 + x) \\ &= -f(x) \end{aligned}$$

Therefore f is an odd function.

$$\text{(b)} \quad g(-x) = 1 - (-x)^4 = 1 - x^4 = g(x)$$

So g is even.

$$\text{(c)} \quad h(-x) = 2(-x) - (-x)^2 = -2x - x^2$$

Since $h(-x) \neq h(x)$ and $h(-x) \neq -h(x)$, we conclude that h is neither even nor odd. ■

The graphs of the functions in Example 12 are shown in Figure 22. Notice that the graph of h is symmetric neither about the y -axis nor about the origin.

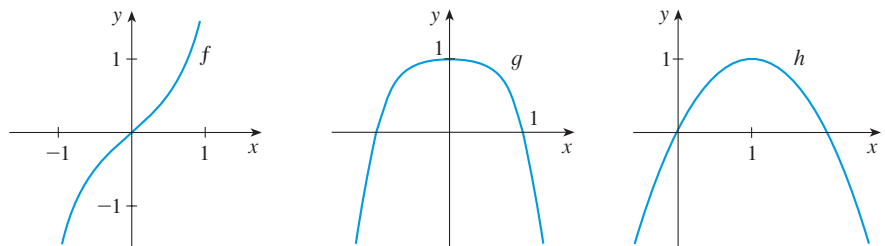


FIGURE 22 (a) Odd function (b) Even function (c) Neither even nor odd

■ Periodic Functions

Many phenomena in the life sciences display a recurring type of behavior: from breathing, to the beating of the heart, to the cycling of female reproductive hormones, to seasonal migration of butterflies. Such phenomena are referred to as *periodic*. To describe such processes mathematically we need functions that display this behavior.

Definition A function f is called **periodic** if there is a positive constant T such that $f(x + T) = f(x)$ for all values of x in the domain of f . The smallest value of T for which this is true is called the **period** of f .

The electrocardiogram shown in Figure 1 on page 2 is an example of an approximately periodic function. The period of the function V appears to be about 0.9 seconds: $V(t + 0.9) \approx V(t)$. The trigonometric functions are also periodic and are discussed in the next section.

EXAMPLE 13 | **BB** **Malarial fever** Figure 23 shows a typical temperature chart for a fever in humans induced by a species of malaria called *P. vivax*. Notice that the temperature approximately satisfies

$$T(t + 48) = T(t)$$

so the temperature function has a period of about 48 hours.

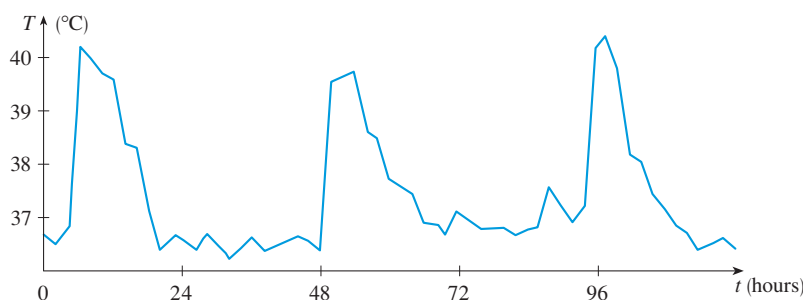


FIGURE 23

Temperature chart for *P. vivax* infection

Source: Adapted from L. Bruce-Chwatt, *Essential Malariology* (New York: Wiley, 1985).

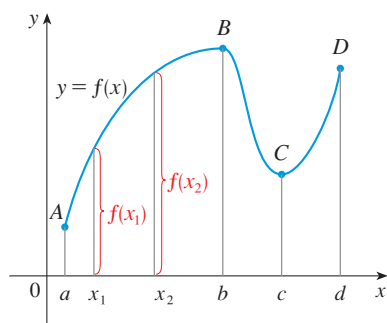


FIGURE 24

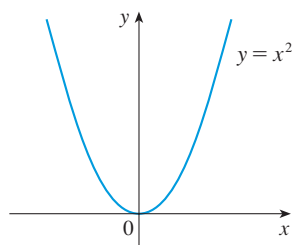


FIGURE 25

■ Increasing and Decreasing Functions

The graph shown in Figure 24 rises from A to B , falls from B to C , and rises again from C to D . The function f is said to be increasing on the interval $[a, b]$, decreasing on $[b, c]$, and increasing again on $[c, d]$. Notice that if x_1 and x_2 are any two numbers between a and b with $x_1 < x_2$, then $f(x_1) < f(x_2)$. We use this as the defining property of an increasing function.

Definition A function f is called **increasing** on an interval I if

$$f(x_1) < f(x_2) \quad \text{whenever } x_1 < x_2 \text{ in } I$$

It is called **decreasing** on I if

$$f(x_1) > f(x_2) \quad \text{whenever } x_1 < x_2 \text{ in } I$$

In the definition of an increasing function it is important to realize that the inequality $f(x_1) < f(x_2)$ must be satisfied for *every* pair of numbers x_1 and x_2 in I with $x_1 < x_2$.

You can see from Figure 25 that the function $f(x) = x^2$ is decreasing on the interval $(-\infty, 0]$ and increasing on the interval $[0, \infty)$.

EXERCISES 1.1

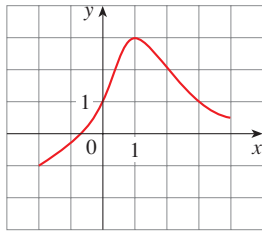
1. If $f(x) = x + \sqrt{2 - x}$ and $g(u) = u + \sqrt{2 - u}$, is it true that $f = g$?

2. If

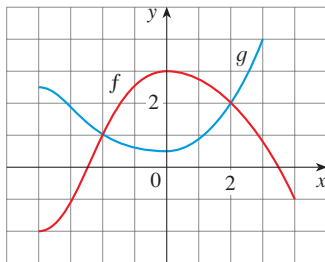
$$f(x) = \frac{x^2 - x}{x - 1} \quad \text{and} \quad g(x) = x$$

is it true that $f = g$?

3. The graph of a function f is given.
- State the value of $f(1)$.
 - Estimate the value of $f(-1)$.
 - For what values of x is $f(x) = 1$?
 - Estimate the value of x such that $f(x) = 0$.
 - State the domain and range of f .
 - On what interval is f increasing?

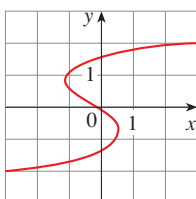


4. The graphs of f and g are given.
- State the values of $f(-4)$ and $g(3)$.
 - For what values of x is $f(x) = g(x)$?
 - Estimate the solution of the equation $f(x) = -1$.
 - On what interval is f decreasing?
 - State the domain and range of f .
 - State the domain and range of g .

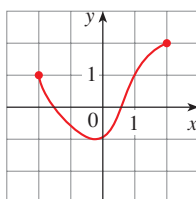


5–8 Determine whether the curve is the graph of a function of x . If it is, state the domain and range of the function.

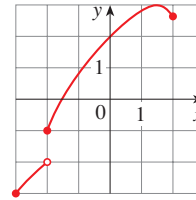
- 5.



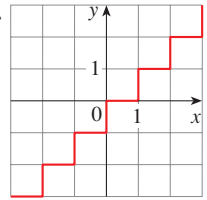
- 6.



- 7.

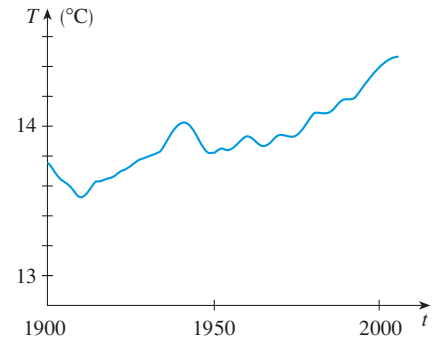


- 8.



9. **Global temperature** Shown is a graph of the global average temperature T during the 20th century.

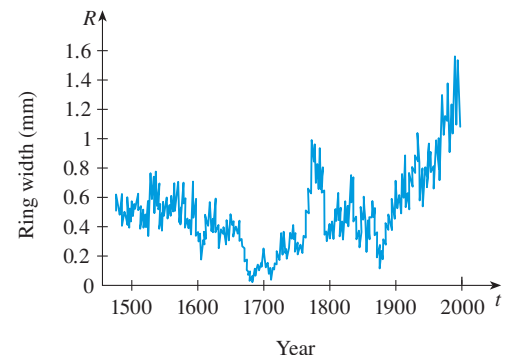
- What was the global average temperature in 1950?
- In what year was the average temperature 14.2° ?
- When was the temperature smallest? Largest?
- Estimate the range of T .



Source: Adapted from *Globe and Mail* [Toronto] 5 Dec. 2009. Print.

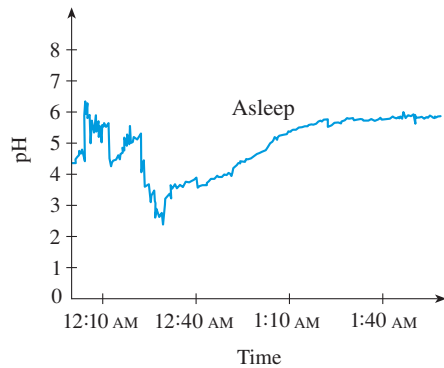
10. **Tree ring width** Trees grow faster and form wider rings in warm years and grow more slowly and form narrower rings in cooler years. The figure shows ring widths of a Siberian pine from 1500 to 2000.

- What is the range of the ring width function?
- What does the graph tend to say about the temperature of the earth? Does the graph reflect the volcanic eruptions of the mid-19th century?



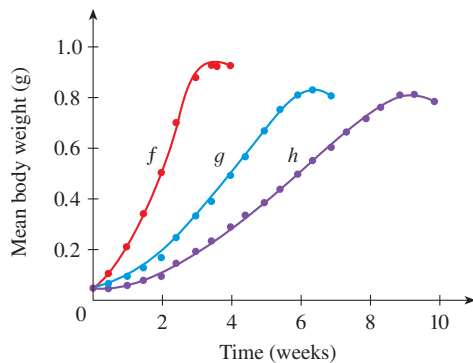
Source: Adapted from G. Jacoby et al., "Mongolian Tree Rings and 20th-Century Warming," *Science* 273 (1996): 771–73.

- 11. Esophageal pH** A healthy esophagus has a pH of about 7.0. When acid reflux occurs, stomach acid (which has pH ranging from 1.0 to 3.0) flows backward from the stomach into the esophagus. When the pH of the esophagus is less than 4.0, the episode is called “clinical acid reflux” and can cause ulcers and damage the lining of the esophagus. The graph shows esophageal pH for a sleeping patient with acid reflux. During what time interval is the patient considered to have an episode of clinical acid reflux?



Source: Adapted from T. Demeester et al., “Patterns of Gastroesophageal Reflux in Health and Disease,” *Annals of Surgery* 184 (1976): 459–70.

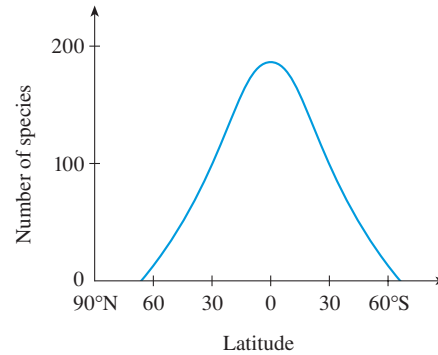
- 12. Tadpole weights** The figure shows the average body weights of tadpoles raised in different densities. The function f shows body weights when the density is 10 tadpoles/L. For functions g and h the densities are 80 and 160 tadpoles/L, respectively. What do these graphs tell you about the effect of crowding?



Source: Adapted from P. Russell et al., *Biology: The Dynamic Science* (Belmont, CA: Cengage Learning, 2011), 1156.

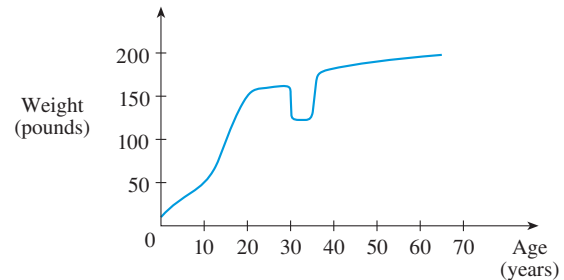
- 13. Species richness** Tropical regions receive more rainfall and intense sunlight and have longer growing seasons than regions farther from the equator. As a result, they enjoy greater species richness, that is, greater numbers of species. The graph shows how species richness varies with latitude for ants.
- (a) How many species would you expect to find at 30°S ? At 20°N ?

- (b) If you found about 100 ant species at a certain location, at roughly what latitude would you be?
- (c) What symmetry property does this function possess?

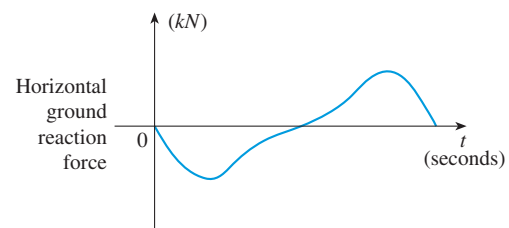


Source: Adapted from P. Russell et al., *Biology: The Dynamic Science* (Belmont, CA: Cengage Learning, 2011), 1190.

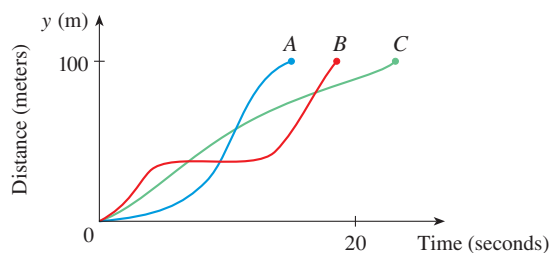
- 14.** In this section we discussed examples of ordinary, everyday functions: Population is a function of time, postage cost is a function of weight, water temperature is a function of time. Give three other examples of functions from everyday life that are described verbally. What can you say about the domain and range of each of your functions? If possible, sketch a rough graph of each function.
- 15.** The graph shown gives the weight of a certain person as a function of age. Describe in words how this person’s weight varies over time. What do you think happened when this person was 30 years old?



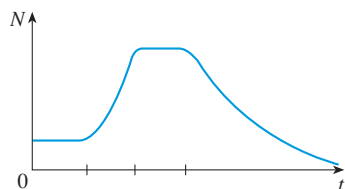
- 16. Ground reaction force in walking** The graph shows the horizontal force exerted by the ground on a person during walking. Positive values are forces in the forward direction and negative values are forces in the backward direction. Give an explanation for the shape of the graph of the force function, including the points where it crosses the axis.



17. You put some ice cubes in a glass, fill the glass with cold water, and then let the glass sit on a table. Describe how the temperature of the water changes as time passes. Then sketch a rough graph of the temperature of the water as a function of the elapsed time.
18. Three runners compete in a 100-meter race. The graph depicts the distance run as a function of time for each runner. Describe in words what the graph tells you about this race. Who won the race? Did each runner finish the race?



19. **Bacteria count** Shown is a typical graph of the number N of bacteria grown in a batch culture as a function of time t . Describe what you think is happening during each of the four phases.



20. Sketch a rough graph of the number of hours of daylight as a function of the time of year.
21. Sketch a rough graph of the outdoor temperature as a function of time during a typical spring day.
22. You place a frozen pie in an oven and bake it for an hour. Then you take it out and let it cool before eating it. Describe how the temperature of the pie changes as time passes. Then sketch a rough graph of the temperature of the pie as a function of time.
23. Sketch the graph of the amount of a particular brand of coffee sold by a store as a function of the price of the coffee.
24. Sketch a rough graph of the market value of a new car as a function of time for a period of 20 years. Assume the car is well maintained.
25. **Bird count** The table shows the number of house finches, in thousands, observed in the Christmas bird count in California.

Year	1980	1985	1990	1995	2000	2005	2010
Count	74	92	88	107	70	61	78

- (a) Use the data to sketch a rough graph of the bird count as a function of time.
- (b) Use your graph to estimate the count in 1997.

26. **Blood alcohol concentration** Researchers measured the blood alcohol concentration (BAC) of eight adult male subjects after rapid consumption of 30 mL of ethanol (corresponding to two standard alcoholic drinks). The table shows the data they obtained by averaging the BAC (in mg/mL) of the eight men.

t (hours)	0.0	0.2	0.5	0.75	1.0	1.25	1.5
BAC	0	0.25	0.41	0.40	0.33	0.29	0.24

t (hours)	1.75	2.0	2.25	2.5	3.0	3.5	4.0
BAC	0.22	0.18	0.15	0.12	0.07	0.03	0.01

- (a) Use the readings to sketch the graph of the BAC as a function of t .
- (b) Use your graph to describe how the concentration of alcohol varies with time.

Source: Adapted from P. Wilkinson et al., "Pharmacokinetics of Ethanol after Oral Administration in the Fasting State," *Journal of Pharmacokinetics and Biopharmaceutics* 5 (1977): 207–24.

27. If $f(x) = 3x^2 - x + 2$, find $f(2)$, $f(-2)$, $f(a)$, $f(-a)$, $f(a+1)$, $2f(a)$, $f(2a)$, $f(a^2)$, $[f(a)]^2$, and $f(a+h)$.
28. A spherical balloon with radius r inches has volume $V(r) = \frac{4}{3}\pi r^3$. Find a function that represents the amount of air required to inflate the balloon from a radius of r inches to a radius of $r+1$ inches.

29–32 Evaluate the difference quotient for the given function. Simplify your answer.

29. $f(x) = 4 + 3x - x^2$, $\frac{f(3+h) - f(3)}{h}$

30. $f(x) = x^3$, $\frac{f(a+h) - f(a)}{h}$

31. $f(x) = \frac{1}{x}$, $\frac{f(x) - f(a)}{x - a}$

32. $f(x) = \frac{x+3}{x+1}$, $\frac{f(x) - f(1)}{x - 1}$

33–39 Find the domain of the function.

33. $f(x) = \frac{x+4}{x^2-9}$

34. $f(x) = \frac{2x^3-5}{x^2+x-6}$

35. $f(t) = \sqrt[3]{2t-1}$

36. $g(t) = \sqrt{3-t} - \sqrt{2+t}$

37. $h(x) = \frac{1}{\sqrt[3]{x^2-5x}}$

38. $f(u) = \frac{u+1}{1 + \frac{1}{u+1}}$

39. $F(p) = \sqrt{2 - \sqrt{p}}$

40. Find the domain and range and sketch the graph of the function $h(x) = \sqrt{4 - x^2}$.

41–52 Find the domain and sketch the graph of the function.

41. $f(x) = 2 - 0.4x$

42. $F(x) = x^2 - 2x + 1$

43. $f(t) = 2t + t^2$

44. $H(t) = \frac{4 - t^2}{2 - t}$

45. $g(x) = \sqrt{x - 5}$

46. $F(x) = |2x + 1|$

47. $G(x) = \frac{3x + |x|}{x}$

48. $g(x) = |x| - x$

49. $f(x) = \begin{cases} x + 2 & \text{if } x < 0 \\ 1 - x & \text{if } x \geq 0 \end{cases}$

50. $f(x) = \begin{cases} 3 - \frac{1}{2}x & \text{if } x \leq 2 \\ 2x - 5 & \text{if } x > 2 \end{cases}$

51. $f(x) = \begin{cases} x + 2 & \text{if } x \leq -1 \\ x^2 & \text{if } x > -1 \end{cases}$

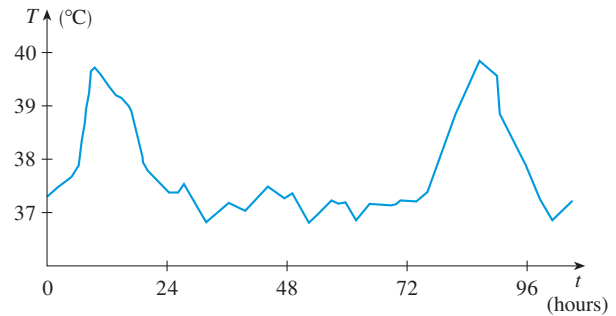
52. $f(x) = \begin{cases} x + 9 & \text{if } x < -3 \\ -2x & \text{if } |x| \leq 3 \\ -6 & \text{if } x > 3 \end{cases}$

53–57 Find a formula for the described function and state its domain.

53. A rectangle has perimeter 20 m. Express the area of the rectangle as a function of the length of one of its sides.
54. A rectangle has area 16 m^2 . Express the perimeter of the rectangle as a function of the length of one of its sides.
55. Express the area of an equilateral triangle as a function of the length of a side.
56. Express the surface area of a cube as a function of its volume.
57. An open rectangular box with volume 2 m^3 has a square base. Express the surface area of the box as a function of the length of a side of the base.
58. A cell phone plan has a basic charge of \$35 a month. The plan includes 400 free minutes and charges 10 cents for each additional minute of usage. Write the monthly cost C as a function of the number x of minutes used and graph C as a function of x for $0 \leq x \leq 600$.
59. A hotel chain charges \$75 each night for the first two nights and \$50 for each additional night's stay. Express the total cost T as a function of the number of nights x that a guest stays.

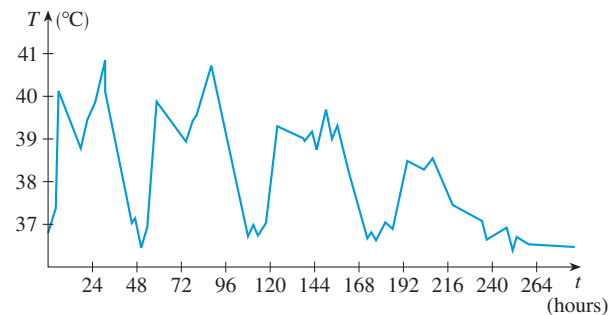
60. The function in Example 11 is called a *step function* because its graph looks like stairs. Give two other examples of step functions that arise in everyday life.

- 61. Temperature chart** The figure shows the temperature of a patient infected with the malaria species *P. malariae*. Estimate the period of the temperature function.



Source: Adapted from L. Bruce-Chwatt, *Essential Malariology* (New York: Wiley, 1985).

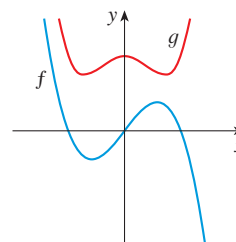
- 62. Malarial fever** A temperature chart is shown for a patient with a fever induced by the malaria species *P. falciparum*. What do you think is happening?



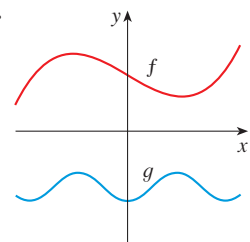
Source: Adapted from L. Bruce-Chwatt, *Essential Malariology* (New York: Wiley, 1985).

- 63–64** Graphs of f and g are shown. Decide whether each function is even, odd, or neither. Explain your reasoning.

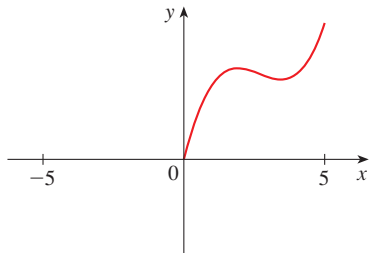
63.



64.



65. (a) If the point (5, 3) is on the graph of an even function, what other point must also be on the graph?
(b) If the point (5, 3) is on the graph of an odd function, what other point must also be on the graph?
66. A function f has domain $[-5, 5]$ and a portion of its graph is shown.
- (a) Complete the graph of f if it is known that f is even.
(b) Complete the graph of f if it is known that f is odd.



- 67–72 Determine whether f is even, odd, or neither. If you have a graphing calculator, use it to check your answer visually.
67. $f(x) = \frac{x}{x^2 + 1}$ 68. $f(x) = \frac{x^2}{x^4 + 1}$
69. $f(x) = \frac{x}{x + 1}$ 70. $f(x) = x|x|$
71. $f(x) = 1 + 3x^2 - x^4$ 72. $f(x) = 1 + 3x^3 - x^5$
-
73. If f and g are both even functions, is $f + g$ even? If f and g are both odd functions, is $f + g$ odd? What if f is even and g is odd? Justify your answers.
74. If f and g are both even functions, is the product fg even? If f and g are both odd functions, is fg odd? What if f is even and g is odd? Justify your answers.

1.2 | A Catalog of Essential Functions

In *Case Studies in Mathematical Modeling* (page xli), we discussed the idea of a mathematical model and the process of mathematical modeling. There are many different types of functions that can be used to model relationships observed in the real world. In this section we discuss the behavior and graphs of these functions and give examples of situations appropriately modeled by such functions.

Linear Models

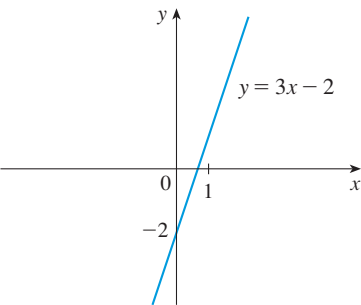
The coordinate geometry of lines is reviewed in Appendix B.

When we say that y is a **linear function** of x , we mean that the graph of the function is a line, so we can use the slope-intercept form of the equation of a line to write a formula for the function as

$$y = f(x) = mx + b$$

where m is the slope of the line and b is the y -intercept.

A characteristic feature of linear functions is that they grow at a constant rate. For instance, Figure 1 shows a graph of the linear function $f(x) = 3x - 2$ and a table of sample values. Notice that whenever x increases by 0.1, the value of $f(x)$ increases by 0.3. So $f(x)$ increases three times as fast as x . Thus the slope of the graph $y = 3x - 2$, namely 3, can be interpreted as the rate of change of y with respect to x .



x	$f(x) = 3x - 2$
1.0	1.0
1.1	1.3
1.2	1.6
1.3	1.9
1.4	2.2
1.5	2.5

FIGURE 1

A special case of a linear function occurs when we talk about *direct variation*. If the quantities x and y are related by an equation $y = kx$ for some constant $k \neq 0$, we say that y **varies directly as x** , or y is **proportional to x** . The constant k is called the **constant of proportionality**. Equivalently, we can write $f(x) = kx$, where f is a linear function whose graph has slope k and y -intercept 0.

EXAMPLE 1

- (a) As dry air moves upward, it expands and cools. If the ground temperature is 20°C and the temperature at a height of 1 km is 10°C , express the temperature T (in $^\circ\text{C}$) as a function of the height h (in kilometers), assuming that a linear model is appropriate.
 (b) Draw the graph of the function in part (a). What does the slope represent?
 (c) What is the temperature at a height of 2.5 km?

SOLUTION

- (a) Because we are assuming that T is a linear function of h , we can write

$$T = mh + b$$

We are given that $T = 20$ when $h = 0$, so

$$20 = m \cdot 0 + b = b$$

In other words, the y -intercept is $b = 20$.

We are also given that $T = 10$ when $h = 1$, so

$$10 = m \cdot 1 + 20$$

The slope of the line is therefore $m = 10 - 20 = -10$ and the required linear function is

$$T = -10h + 20$$

- (b) The graph is sketched in Figure 2. The slope is $m = -10^\circ\text{C}/\text{km}$, and this represents the rate of change of temperature with respect to height.

- (c) At a height of $h = 2.5$ km, the temperature is

$$T = -10(2.5) + 20 = -5^\circ\text{C}$$

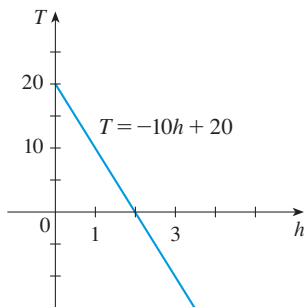


FIGURE 2

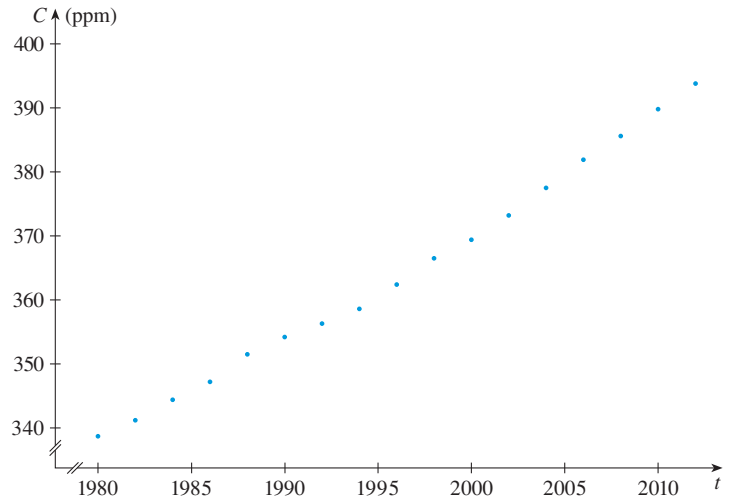
If there is no physical law or principle to help us formulate a model, we construct an **empirical model**, which is based entirely on collected data. We seek a curve that “fits” the data in the sense that it captures the basic trend of the data points.

EXAMPLE 2 | BB Carbon dioxide in the atmosphere Table 1 lists the average carbon dioxide level in the atmosphere, measured in parts per million at Mauna Loa Observatory from 1980 to 2012. Use the data in Table 1 to find a model for the carbon dioxide level.

SOLUTION We use the data in Table 1 to make the scatter plot in Figure 3, where t represents time (in years) and C represents the CO_2 level (in parts per million, ppm).

Table 1

Year	CO ₂ level (in ppm)	Year	CO ₂ level (in ppm)
1980	338.7	1998	366.5
1982	341.2	2000	369.4
1984	344.4	2002	373.2
1986	347.2	2004	377.5
1988	351.5	2006	381.9
1990	354.2	2008	385.6
1992	356.3	2010	389.9
1994	358.6	2012	393.8
1996	362.4		

FIGURE 3 Scatter plot for the average CO₂ level

Notice that the data points appear to lie close to a straight line, so it's natural to choose a linear model in this case. But there are many possible lines that approximate these data points, so which one should we use? One possibility is the line that passes through the first and last data points. The slope of this line is

$$\frac{393.8 - 338.7}{2012 - 1980} = \frac{55.1}{32} = 1.721875 \approx 1.722$$

We write its equation as

$$C - 338.7 = 1.722(t - 1980)$$

or

$$(1) \quad C = 1.722t - 3070.86$$

Equation 1 gives one possible linear model for the carbon dioxide level; it is graphed in Figure 4.

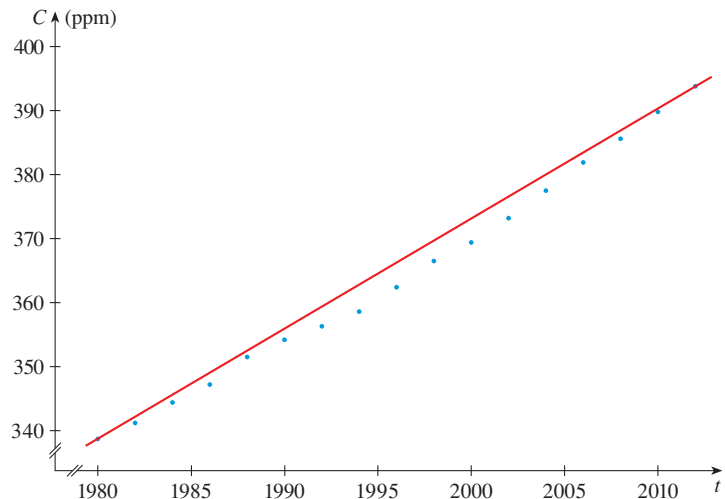


FIGURE 4
Linear model through
first and last data points

A computer or graphing calculator finds the regression line by the method of **least squares**, which is to minimize the sum of the squares of the vertical distances between the data points and the line. The details are explained in Section 11.3.

Notice that our model gives values higher than most of the actual CO₂ levels. A better linear model is obtained by a procedure from statistics called *linear regression*. If we use a graphing calculator, we enter the data from Table 1 into the data editor and choose the linear regression command. (With Maple we use the `fit[leastsquare]` command in the stats package; with Mathematica we use the `Fit` command.) The machine gives the slope and y-intercept of the regression line as

$$m = 1.71262 \quad b = -3054.14$$

So our least squares model for the CO₂ level is

$$(2) \quad C = 1.71262t - 3054.14$$

In Figure 5 we graph the regression line as well as the data points. Comparing with Figure 4, we see that it gives a better fit than our previous linear model.

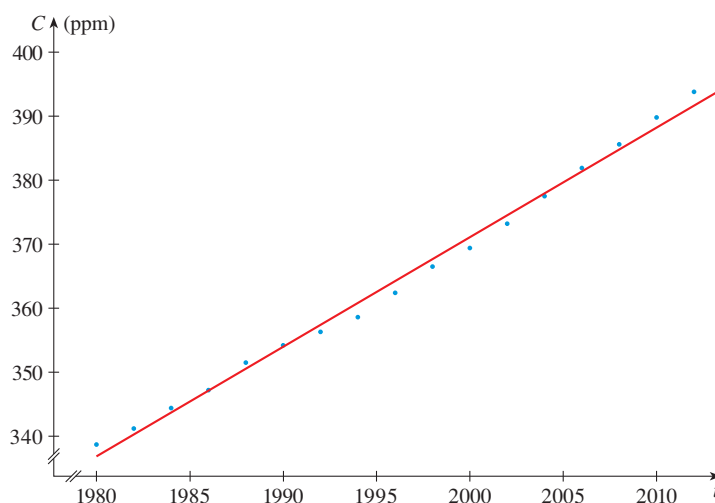


FIGURE 5
The regression line

EXAMPLE 3 | Interpolating and extrapolating the CO₂ level Use the linear model given by Equation 2 to estimate the average CO₂ level for 1987 and to predict the level for the year 2020. According to this model, when will the CO₂ level exceed 420 parts per million?

SOLUTION Using Equation 2 with $t = 1987$, we estimate that the average CO₂ level in 1987 was

$$C(1987) = (1.71262)(1987) - 3054.14 \approx 348.84$$

This is an example of *interpolation* because we have estimated a value *between* observed values. (In fact, the Mauna Loa Observatory reported that the average CO₂ level in 1987 was 348.93 ppm, so our estimate is remarkably accurate.)

With $t = 2020$, we get

$$C(2020) = (1.71262)(2020) - 3054.14 \approx 405.35$$

So we predict that the average CO₂ level in the year 2020 will be 405.4 ppm. This is an example of *extrapolation* because we have predicted a value *outside* the time frame of observations. Consequently, we are far less certain about the accuracy of our prediction.

Using Equation 2, we see that the CO₂ level exceeds 420 ppm when

$$1.71262t - 3054.14 > 420$$

Solving this inequality, we get

$$t > \frac{3474.14}{1.71262} \approx 2028.55$$

We therefore predict that the CO₂ level will exceed 420 ppm by the year 2029. This prediction is risky because it involves a time quite remote from our observations. In fact, we see from Figure 5 that the trend has been for CO₂ levels to increase rather more rapidly in recent years, so the level might exceed 420 ppm well before 2029. ■

Polynomials

A function P is called a **polynomial** if

$$P(x) = a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_2 x^2 + a_1 x + a_0$$

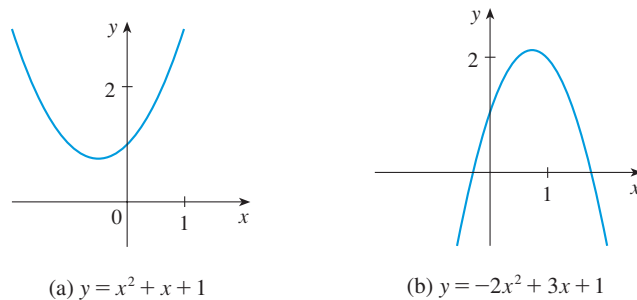
where n is a nonnegative integer and the numbers $a_0, a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$ are constants called the **coefficients** of the polynomial. The domain of any polynomial is $\mathbb{R} = (-\infty, \infty)$. If the leading coefficient $a_n \neq 0$, then the **degree** of the polynomial is n . For example, the function

$$P(x) = 2x^6 - x^4 + \frac{2}{5}x^3 + \sqrt{2}$$

is a polynomial of degree 6.

A polynomial of degree 1 is of the form $P(x) = mx + b$ and so it is a linear function. A polynomial of degree 2 is of the form $P(x) = ax^2 + bx + c$ and is called a **quadratic function**. Its graph is always a parabola obtained by shifting the parabola $y = ax^2$, as we will see in the next section. The parabola opens upward if $a > 0$ and downward if $a < 0$. (See Figure 6.)

FIGURE 6
The graphs of quadratic functions are parabolas.

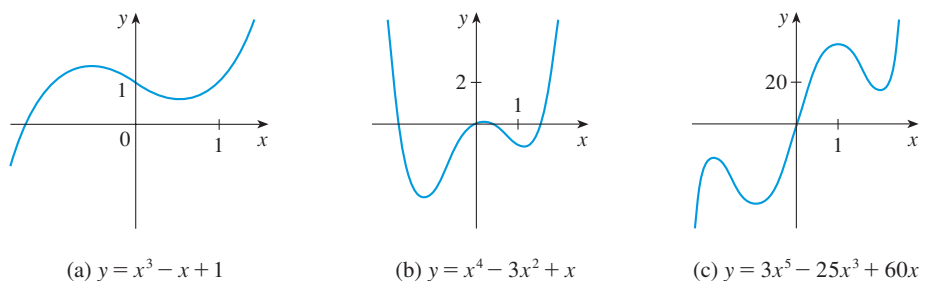


A polynomial of degree 3 is of the form

$$P(x) = ax^3 + bx^2 + cx + d \quad a \neq 0$$

and is called a **cubic function**. Figure 7 shows the graph of a cubic function in part (a) and graphs of polynomials of degrees 4 and 5 in parts (b) and (c). We will see later why the graphs have these shapes.

FIGURE 7



Polynomials are commonly used to model various quantities that occur in biology. Figure 8 shows a quadratic model of the vertical trajectory of zebra finches. (Digitized points representing the position of the bird’s eye were used in fitting the curve.) Such birds use “flap-bounding.” This means that they flap their wings rapidly to gain dynamic energy and then fold their wings into their body for a period of time and act as a projectile.

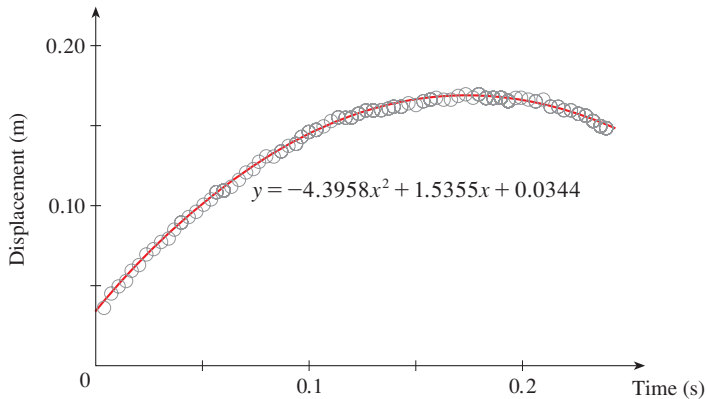


FIGURE 8 Zebra finch trajectory
Source: Adapted from B. Tobalske et al., “Kinematics of Flap-Bounding Flight in the Zebra Finch Over a Wide Range of Speeds,” *Journal of Experimental Biology* 202 (1999): 1725–39.

In the following example we use a quadratic function to model the fall of a ball.

EXAMPLE 4 | A ball is dropped from the upper observation deck of the CN Tower, 450 m above the ground, and its height h above the ground is recorded at 1-second intervals in Table 2. Find a model to fit the data and use the model to predict the time at which the ball hits the ground.

SOLUTION We draw a scatter plot of the data in Figure 9 and observe that a linear model is inappropriate. But it looks as if the data points might lie on a parabola, so we try a quadratic model instead. Using a graphing calculator or computer algebra system (which uses the least squares method), we obtain the following quadratic model:

(3)
$$h = 449.36 + 0.96t - 4.90t^2$$

Table 2

Time (seconds)	Height (meters)
0	450
1	445
2	431
3	408
4	375
5	332
6	279
7	216
8	143
9	61

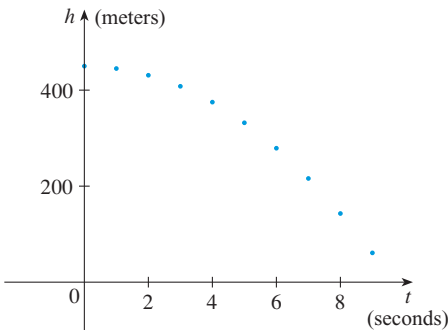


FIGURE 9
Scatter plot for a falling ball

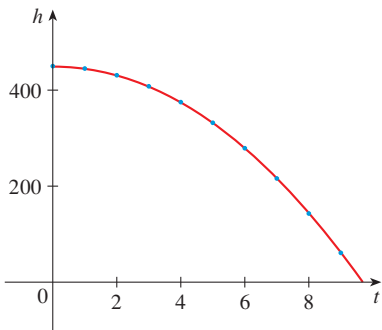


FIGURE 10
Quadratic model for a falling ball

In Figure 10 we plot the graph of Equation 3 together with the data points and see that the quadratic model gives a very good fit.

The ball hits the ground when $h = 0$, so we solve the quadratic equation

$$-4.90t^2 + 0.96t + 449.36 = 0$$

The quadratic formula gives

$$t = \frac{-0.96 \pm \sqrt{(0.96)^2 - 4(-4.90)(449.36)}}{2(-4.90)}$$

The positive root is $t \approx 9.67$, so we predict that the ball will hit the ground after about 9.7 seconds. ■

If a scatter plot of data has a single peak, then it may be appropriate to use a quadratic polynomial as a model (as in Figure 8). But the more fluctuation the data exhibit, the higher the degree of the polynomial needed to model the data. In particular, marine biologists sometimes use cubic polynomials to model the length of fish as a function of age in order to track fish populations. (See Exercise 27.) Then the model can be used to estimate the age of fish whose length has been measured.

■ Power Functions

A function of the form $f(x) = x^p$, where p is a constant, is called a **power function**. We consider several cases.

(i) $p = n$, where n is a positive integer

The graphs of $f(x) = x^n$ for $n = 1, 2, 3, 4$, and 5 are shown in Figure 11. (These are polynomials with only one term.) We already know the shape of the graphs of $y = x$ (a line through the origin with slope 1) and $y = x^2$ [a parabola, see Example 1.1.2(b)].

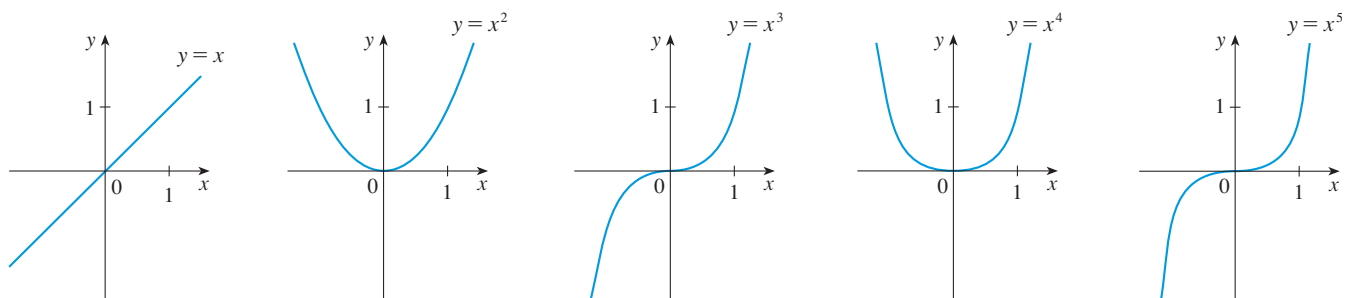


FIGURE 11 Graphs of $f(x) = x^n$ for $n = 1, 2, 3, 4, 5$

The general shape of the graph of $f(x) = x^n$ depends on whether n is even or odd. If n is even, then $f(x) = x^n$ is an even function and its graph is similar to the parabola $y = x^2$. If n is odd, then $f(x) = x^n$ is an odd function and its graph is similar to that of $y = x^3$. Notice from Figure 12 (on page 24), however, that as n increases, the graph of $y = x^n$ becomes flatter near 0 and steeper when $|x| \geq 1$. (If x is small, then x^2 is smaller, x^3 is even smaller, x^4 is smaller still, and so on.)

A **family of functions** is a collection of functions whose equations are related. Figure 12 shows two families of power functions, one with even powers and one with odd powers.

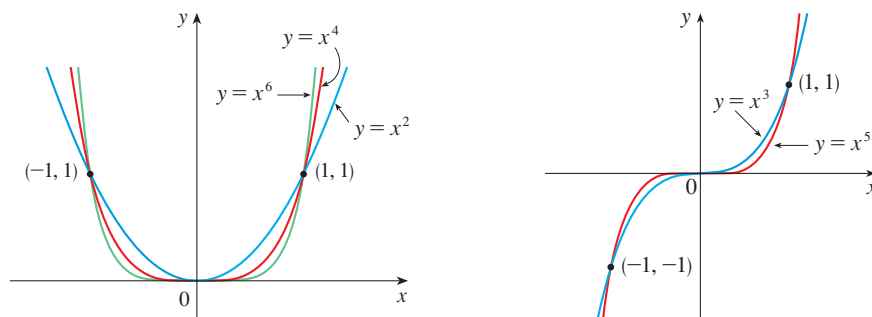


FIGURE 12

(ii) $p = 1/n$, where n is a positive integer

The function $f(x) = x^{1/n} = \sqrt[n]{x}$ is a **root function**. For $n = 2$ it is the square root function $f(x) = \sqrt{x}$, whose domain is $[0, \infty)$ and whose graph is the upper half of the parabola $x = y^2$. [See Figure 13(a).] For other even values of n , the graph of $y = \sqrt[n]{x}$ is similar to that of $y = \sqrt{x}$. For $n = 3$ we have the cube root function $f(x) = \sqrt[3]{x}$ whose domain is $\mathbb{R}$ (recall that every real number has a cube root) and whose graph is shown in Figure 13(b). The graph of $y = \sqrt[n]{x}$ for n odd ($n > 3$) is similar to that of $y = \sqrt[3]{x}$.

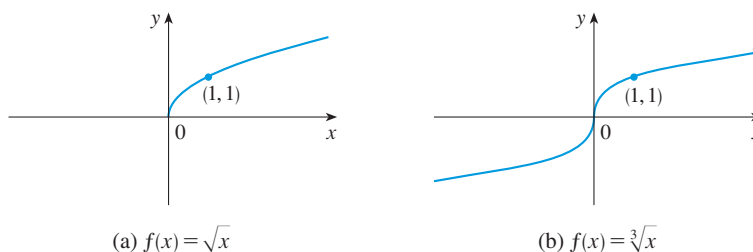


FIGURE 13

Graphs of root functions

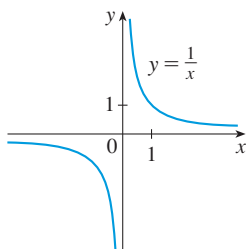


FIGURE 14

The reciprocal function

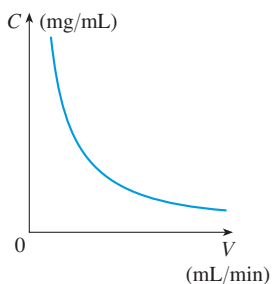


FIGURE 15

Concentration of CO_2 as a function of ventilation rate

(iii) $p = -1$

The graph of the **reciprocal function** $f(x) = x^{-1} = 1/x$ is shown in Figure 14. Its graph has the equation $y = 1/x$, or $xy = 1$, and is a hyperbola with the coordinate axes as its asymptotes. This function arises in many areas of the life sciences; one such area is described in the following example.

EXAMPLE 5 | **BB Anesthesiology**¹ Anesthesiologists often put patients on ventilators during surgery to maintain a steady state concentration C of carbon dioxide in the lungs. If P is the rate of production of CO_2 by the body (measured in mg/min) and V is the ventilation rate (measured as lung volume exchanged per minute, mL/min), then at steady state the production of CO_2 exactly balances removal by ventilation:

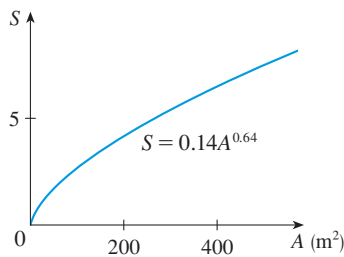
$$P \frac{\text{mg}}{\text{min}} = \left(C \frac{\text{mg}}{\text{mL}} \right) \left(V \frac{\text{mL}}{\text{min}} \right)$$

Thus the steady state concentration of CO_2 is inversely proportional to the ventilation rate:

$$C = \frac{P}{V}$$

where P is a constant. The graph of C as a function of V is shown in Figure 15 and has the same general shape as the right half of Figure 14.

1. Adapted from S. Cruickshank, *Mathematics and Statistics in Anaesthesia* (New York: Oxford University Press, USA, 1998).

**FIGURE 16**

The number of different bat species in a cave is related to the size of the cave by a power function.

Source: Derived from A. Brunet et al., “The Species–Area Relationship in Bat Assemblages of Tropical Caves,” *Journal of Mammalogy* 82 (2001): 1114–22.

EXAMPLE 6 | BB Species richness in bat caves It makes sense that the larger the area of a region, the larger the number of species that inhabit the region. Many ecologists have modeled the species–area relation with a power function and, in particular, the number of species S of bats living in caves in central Mexico has been related to the surface area A of the caves by the equation $S = 0.14A^{0.64}$. (In Example 1.5.14 this model will be derived from collected data.)

- (a) The cave called Misión Imposible near Puebla, Mexico, has a surface area of $A = 60 \text{ m}^2$. How many species of bats would you expect to find in that cave?
 (b) If you discover that four species of bats live in a cave, estimate the area of the cave.

SOLUTION A graph of the power function model is shown in Figure 16.

- (a) According to the model $S = 0.14A^{0.64}$, the expected number of species in a cave with surface area $A = 60 \text{ m}^2$ is

$$S = 0.14(60)^{0.64} \approx 1.92$$

So we would expect there to be two species of bats in this cave.

- (b) For a cave with four species of bats we have

$$S = 0.14A^{0.64} = 4 \Rightarrow A^{0.64} = \frac{4}{0.14}$$

So

$$A = \left(\frac{4}{0.14} \right)^{1/0.64} \approx 188$$

We predict that a cave with four species of bats would have a surface area of about 190 m^2 .

Power functions are also used to model other species–area relationships (Exercise 25), the weight of a bird as a function of wingspan (Exercise 24), illumination as a function of distance from a light source (Exercise 23), and the period of revolution of a planet as a function of its distance from the sun (Exercise 26).

Rational Functions

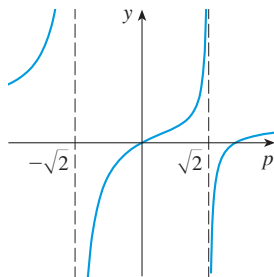
A **rational function** f is a ratio of two polynomials:

$$f(x) = \frac{P(x)}{Q(x)}$$

where P and Q are polynomials. The domain consists of all values of x such that $Q(x) \neq 0$. A simple example of a rational function is the function $f(x) = 1/x$, whose domain is $\{x \mid x \neq 0\}$; this is the reciprocal function graphed in Figure 14. The function

$$f(p) = \frac{p^2 - 2p}{p^2 - 2}$$

arises in models for the spread of drug resistance (see the project on page 78) and is a rational function with domain $\{p \mid p \neq \pm\sqrt{2}\}$. Its complete graph is shown in Figure 17, though when we use the model we will restrict this domain.

**FIGURE 17**

Algebraic Functions

A function f is called an **algebraic function** if it can be constructed using algebraic operations (such as addition, subtraction, multiplication, division, and taking roots) starting with polynomials. Any rational function is automatically an algebraic function. Here

are two more examples:

$$f(x) = \sqrt{x^2 + 1} \qquad g(x) = \frac{x^4 - 16x^2}{x + \sqrt{x}} + (x - 2)\sqrt[3]{x + 1}$$

When we sketch algebraic functions in Chapter 4, we will see that their graphs can assume a variety of shapes. Figure 18 illustrates some of the possibilities.

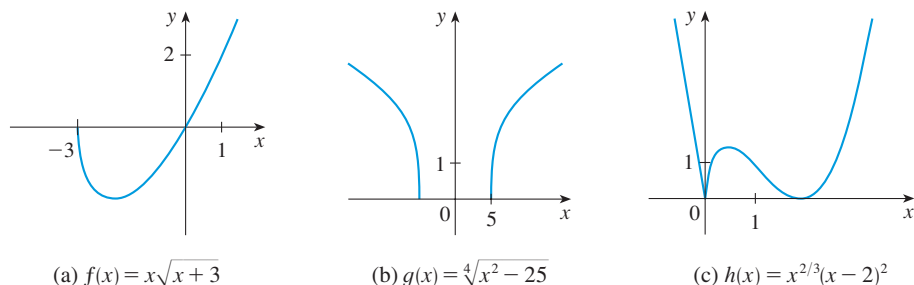


FIGURE 18

An example of an algebraic function occurs in the theory of relativity. The mass of a particle with velocity v is

$$m = f(v) = \frac{m_0}{\sqrt{1 - v^2/c^2}}$$

where m_0 is the rest mass of the particle and $c = 3.0 \times 10^5$ km/s is the speed of light in a vacuum.

■ Trigonometric Functions

The Reference Pages are located at the front of the book.

Curves with this general shape are sometimes called *sinusoidal*.

Trigonometry and the trigonometric functions are reviewed on Reference Page 2 and also in Appendix C. In calculus the convention is that radian measure is always used (except when otherwise indicated). For example, when we use the function $f(x) = \sin x$, it is understood that $\sin x$ means the sine of the angle whose radian measure is x . Thus the graphs of the sine and cosine functions are as shown in Figure 19.

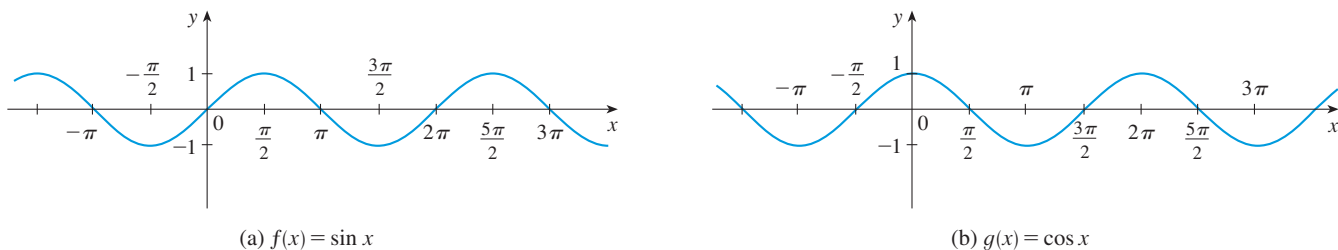


FIGURE 19

Notice that for both the sine and cosine functions the domain is $(-\infty, \infty)$ and the range is the closed interval $[-1, 1]$. Thus, for all values of x , we have

$$-1 \leq \sin x \leq 1 \qquad -1 \leq \cos x \leq 1$$

or, in terms of absolute values,

$$|\sin x| \leq 1 \qquad |\cos x| \leq 1$$

Also, the zeros of the sine function occur at the integer multiples of π ; that is,

$$\sin x = 0 \quad \text{when} \quad x = n\pi \quad n \text{ an integer}$$

The sine and cosine functions are periodic functions and have period 2π ; that is, for all values of x ,

$$\sin(x + 2\pi) = \sin x \quad \cos(x + 2\pi) = \cos x$$

Although the sine and cosine functions are simple periodic functions, they can be manipulated and combined in ways described in Section 1.3 to model a wide variety of periodic phenomena. For instance, in Example 1.3.4 we will see that a reasonable model for the number of hours of daylight in Philadelphia t days after January 1 is given by the function

$$L(t) = 12 + 2.8 \sin \left[\frac{2\pi}{365}(t - 80) \right]$$

The tangent function is related to the sine and cosine functions by the equation

$$\tan x = \frac{\sin x}{\cos x}$$

and its graph is shown in Figure 20. It is undefined whenever $\cos x = 0$, that is, when $x = \pm\pi/2, \pm3\pi/2, \dots$. Its range is $(-\infty, \infty)$. Notice that the tangent function has period π :

$$\tan(x + \pi) = \tan x \quad \text{for all } x$$

The remaining three trigonometric functions (cosecant, secant, and cotangent) are the reciprocals of the sine, cosine, and tangent functions. Their graphs are shown in Appendix C.

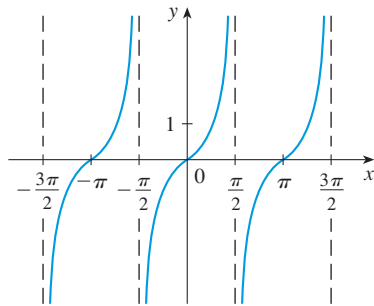


FIGURE 20

$y = \tan x$

Exponential Functions

The **exponential functions** are the functions of the form $f(x) = b^x$, where the base b is a positive constant. The graphs of $y = 2^x$ and $y = (0.5)^x$ are shown in Figure 21. In both cases the domain is $(-\infty, \infty)$ and the range is $(0, \infty)$.

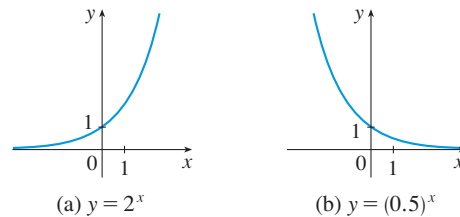


FIGURE 21

Exponential functions will be studied in detail in Section 1.4, and we will see that they are useful for modeling many natural phenomena, such as population growth (if $b > 1$) and radioactive decay (if $b < 1$).

Logarithmic Functions

The logarithmic functions $f(x) = \log_b x$, where the base b is a positive constant, are the inverse functions of the exponential functions. They will be studied in Section 1.5.

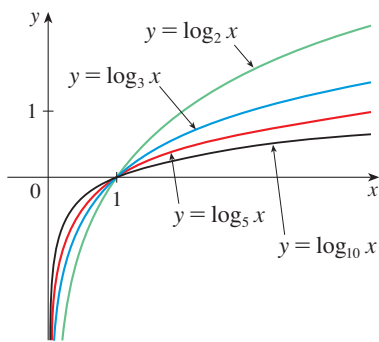


FIGURE 22

Figure 22 shows the graphs of four logarithmic functions with various bases. In each case the domain is $(0, \infty)$, the range is $(-\infty, \infty)$, and the function increases slowly when $x > 1$.

EXAMPLE 7 | Classify the following functions as one of the types of functions that we have discussed.

(a) $f(x) = 5^x$

(b) $g(x) = x^5$

(c) $h(x) = \frac{1+x}{1-\sqrt{x}}$

(d) $u(t) = 1 - t + 5t^4$

SOLUTION

(a) $f(x) = 5^x$ is an exponential function. (The x is the exponent.)

(b) $g(x) = x^5$ is a power function. (The x is the base.) We could also consider it to be a polynomial of degree 5.

(c) $h(x) = \frac{1+x}{1-\sqrt{x}}$ is an algebraic function.

(d) $u(t) = 1 - t + 5t^4$ is a polynomial of degree 4. ■

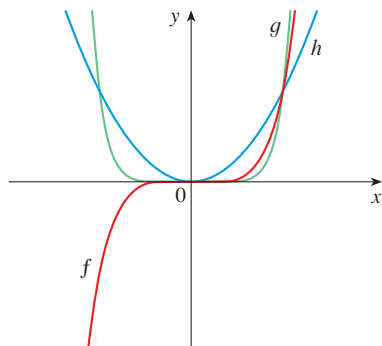
EXERCISES 1.2

1–2 Classify each function as a power function, root function, polynomial (state its degree), rational function, algebraic function, trigonometric function, exponential function, or logarithmic function.

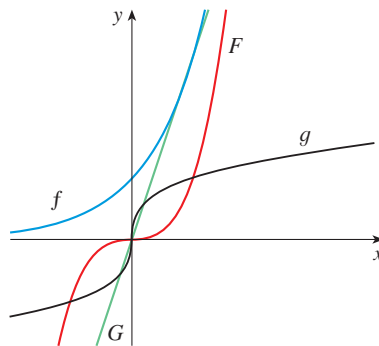
1. (a) $f(x) = \log_2 x$ (b) $g(x) = \sqrt[4]{x}$
 (c) $h(x) = \frac{2x^3}{1-x^2}$ (d) $u(t) = 1 - 1.1t + 2.54t^2$
 (e) $v(t) = 5^t$ (f) $w(\theta) = \sin \theta \cos^2 \theta$
2. (a) $y = \pi^x$ (b) $y = x^\pi$
 (c) $y = x^2(2 - x^3)$ (d) $y = \tan t - \cos t$
 (e) $y = \frac{s}{1+s}$ (f) $y = \frac{\sqrt{x^3 - 1}}{1 + \sqrt[3]{x}}$

3–4 Match each equation with its graph. Explain your choices. (Don't use a computer or graphing calculator.)

3. (a) $y = x^2$ (b) $y = x^5$ (c) $y = x^8$

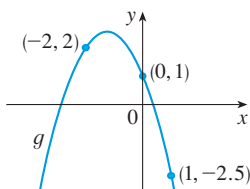
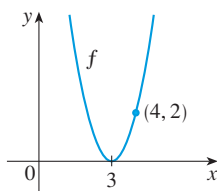


4. (a) $y = 3x$ (b) $y = 3^x$
 (c) $y = x^3$ (d) $y = \sqrt[3]{x}$



5. (a) Find an equation for the family of linear functions with slope 2 and sketch several members of the family.
 (b) Find an equation for the family of linear functions such that $f(2) = 1$ and sketch several members of the family.
 (c) Which function belongs to both families?
6. What do all members of the family of linear functions $f(x) = 1 + m(x + 3)$ have in common? Sketch several members of the family.
7. What do all members of the family of linear functions $f(x) = c - x$ have in common? Sketch several members of the family.

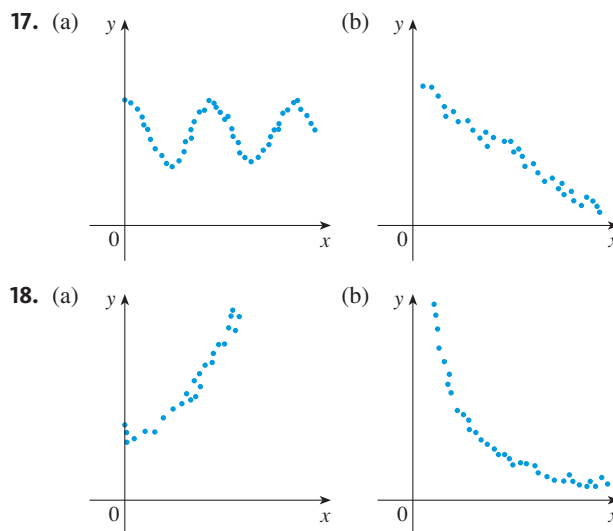
8. Find expressions for the quadratic functions whose graphs are shown.



9. Find an expression for a cubic function f if $f(1) = 6$ and $f(-1) = f(0) = f(2) = 0$.
10. **Climate change** Recent studies indicate that the average surface temperature of the earth has been rising steadily. Some scientists have modeled the temperature by the linear function $T = 0.02t + 8.50$, where T is temperature in $^{\circ}\text{C}$ and t represents years since 1900.
- What do the slope and T -intercept represent?
 - Use the equation to predict the average global surface temperature in 2100.
11. **Drug dosage** If the recommended adult dosage for a drug is D (in mg), then to determine the appropriate dosage c for a child of age a , pharmacists use the equation $c = 0.0417D(a + 1)$. Suppose the dosage for an adult is 200 mg.
- Find the slope of the graph of c . What does it represent?
 - What is the dosage for a newborn?
12. At the surface of the ocean, the water pressure is the same as the air pressure above the water, 15 lb/in². Below the surface, the water pressure increases by 4.34 lb/in² for every 10 ft of descent.
- Express the water pressure as a function of the depth below the ocean surface.
 - At what depth is the pressure 100 lb/in²?
13. The relationship between the Fahrenheit (F) and Celsius (C) temperature scales is given by the linear function $F = \frac{9}{5}C + 32$.
- Sketch a graph of this function.
 - What is the slope of the graph and what does it represent? What is the F -intercept and what does it represent?
14. **Absorbing cerebrospinal fluid** Cerebrospinal fluid is continually produced and reabsorbed by the body at a rate that depends on its current volume. A medical researcher finds that absorption occurs at a rate of 0.35 mL/min when the volume of fluid is 150 mL and at a rate of 0.14 mL/min when the volume is 50 mL.
- Suppose the absorption rate A is a linear function of the volume V . Sketch a graph of $A(V)$.
 - What is the slope of the graph and what does it represent?
 - What is the A -intercept of the graph and what does it represent?

15. Biologists have noticed that the **chirping rate of crickets** of a certain species is related to temperature, and the relationship appears to be very nearly linear. A cricket produces 113 chirps per minute at 70 $^{\circ}\text{F}$ and 173 chirps per minute at 80 $^{\circ}\text{F}$.
- Find a linear equation that models the temperature T as a function of the number of chirps per minute N .
 - What is the slope of the graph? What does it represent?
 - If the crickets are chirping at 150 chirps per minute, estimate the temperature.
16. The monthly cost of driving a car depends on the number of miles driven. Lynn found that in May it cost her \$380 to drive 480 mi and in June it cost her \$460 to drive 800 mi.
- Express the monthly cost C as a function of the distance driven d , assuming that a linear relationship gives a suitable model.
 - Use part (a) to predict the cost of driving 1500 miles per month.
 - Draw the graph of the linear function. What does the slope represent?
 - What does the C -intercept represent?
 - Why does a linear function give a suitable model in this situation?

17–18 For each scatter plot, decide what type of function you might choose as a model for the data. Explain your choices.



-  **19. Peptic ulcer rate** The table on page 30 shows (lifetime) peptic ulcer rates (per 100 population) for various family incomes as reported by the National Health Interview Survey.
- Make a scatter plot of these data and decide whether a linear model is appropriate.
 - Find and graph a linear model using the first and last data points.
 - Find and graph the least squares regression line.

- (d) Use the linear model in part (c) to estimate the ulcer rate for an income of \$25,000.
- (e) According to the model, how likely is someone with an income of \$80,000 to suffer from peptic ulcers?
- (f) Do you think it would be reasonable to apply the model to someone with an income of \$200,000?

Income	Ulcer rate (per 100 population)
\$4,000	14.1
\$6,000	13.0
\$8,000	13.4
\$12,000	12.5
\$16,000	12.0
\$20,000	12.4
\$30,000	10.5
\$45,000	9.4
\$60,000	8.2

-  **20. Cricket chirping rate** In Exercise 15 we modeled temperature as a linear function of the chirping rate of crickets from limited data. Here we use more extensive data in the following table to construct a linear model.

Temperature (°F)	Chirping rate (chirps/min)	Temperature (°F)	Chirping rate (chirps/min)
50	20	75	140
55	46	80	173
60	79	85	198
65	91	90	211
70	113		

- (a) Make a scatter plot of the data.
- (b) Find and graph the regression line.
- (c) Use the linear model in part (b) to estimate the chirping rate at 100°F.

-  **21. Femur length** Anthropologists use a linear model that relates human femur (thighbone) length to height. The model allows an anthropologist to determine the height of an individual when only a partial skeleton (including the femur) is found. Here we find the model by analyzing the data on femur length and height for the eight males given in the following table.

Femur length (cm)	Height (cm)	Femur length (cm)	Height (cm)
50.1	178.5	44.5	168.3
48.3	173.6	42.7	165.0
45.2	164.8	39.5	155.4
44.7	163.7	38.0	155.8

- (a) Make a scatter plot of the data.
- (b) Find and graph the regression line that models the data.
- (c) An anthropologist finds a human femur of length 53 cm. How tall was the person?

-  **22. Asbestos and lung tumors** When laboratory rats are exposed to asbestos fibers, some of them develop lung tumors. The table lists the results of several experiments by different scientists.

- (a) Find the regression line for the data.
- (b) Make a scatter plot and graph the regression line. Does the regression line appear to be a suitable model for the data?
- (c) What does the y-intercept of the regression line represent?

Asbestos exposure (fibers/mL)	Percent of mice that develop lung tumors	Asbestos exposure (fibers/mL)	Percent of mice that develop lung tumors
50	2	1600	42
400	6	1800	37
500	5	2000	38
900	10	3000	50
1100	26		

- 23. Many physical quantities are connected by *inverse square laws*, that is, by power functions of the form $f(x) = kx^{-2}$.** In particular, the illumination of an object by a light source is inversely proportional to the square of the distance from the source. Suppose that after dark you are in a room with just one lamp and you are trying to read a book. The light is too dim and so you move halfway to the lamp. How much brighter is the light?

- 24. Wingspan and weight** The weight W (in pounds) of a bird (that can fly) has been related to the wingspan L (in inches) of the bird by the power function $L = 30.6W^{0.3952}$. (In Exercise 1.5.66 this model will be derived from data.)
- (a) The bald eagle has a wingspan of about 90 inches. Use the model to estimate the weight of the eagle.
- (b) An ostrich weighs about 300 pounds. Use the model to estimate what the wingspan of an ostrich should be in order for it to fly.
- (c) The wingspan of an ostrich is about 72 inches. Use your answer to part (b) to explain why ostriches can't fly.

-  **25. Species–area relation for reptiles** The table shows the number N of species of reptiles and amphibians inhabiting Caribbean islands and the area A of the island in square miles.

- (a) Use a power function to model N as a function of A .
- (b) The Caribbean island of Dominica has area 291 mi². How many species of reptiles and amphibians would you expect to find on Dominica?

Island	A	N
Saba	4	5
Montserrat	40	9
Puerto Rico	3,459	40
Jamaica	4,411	39
Hispaniola	29,418	84
Cuba	44,218	76

-  **26.** The table shows the mean (average) distances d of the planets from the sun (taking the unit of measurement to be the distance from the earth to the sun) and their periods T (time of revolution in years).

Planet	d	T
Mercury	0.387	0.241
Venus	0.723	0.615
Earth	1.000	1.000
Mars	1.523	1.881
Jupiter	5.203	11.861
Saturn	9.541	29.457
Uranus	19.190	84.008
Neptune	30.086	164.784

- (a) Fit a power model to the data.
(b) Kepler’s Third Law of Planetary Motion states that
“The square of the period of revolution of a planet
is proportional to the cube of its mean distance from
the sun.”

Does your model corroborate Kepler’s Third Law?

-  **27. Fish growth** The table gives the lengths of rock bass caught at different ages, as determined by their otoliths

(ear bones in their heads). Scientists have proposed a cubic polynomial to model the data.



Photo by Karna McKinney, AFSC, NOAA Fisheries

- (a) Use a cubic polynomial to model the data. Graph the polynomial together with a scatter plot of the data.
(b) Use your model to estimate the length of a 5-year-old rock bass.
(c) A fisherman catches a rock bass that is 20 inches long. Use your model to estimate its age.

Age (years)	Length (inches)	Age (years)	Length (inches)
1	4.8	9	18.2
2	8.8	9	17.1
2	8.0	10	18.8
3	7.9	10	19.5
4	11.9	11	18.9
5	14.4	12	21.7
6	14.1	12	21.9
6	15.8	13	23.8
7	15.6	14	26.9
8	17.8	14	25.1

1.3 New Functions from Old Functions

In this section we start with the basic functions we discussed in Section 1.2 and obtain new functions by shifting, stretching, and reflecting their graphs. We also show how to combine pairs of functions by the standard arithmetic operations and by composition.

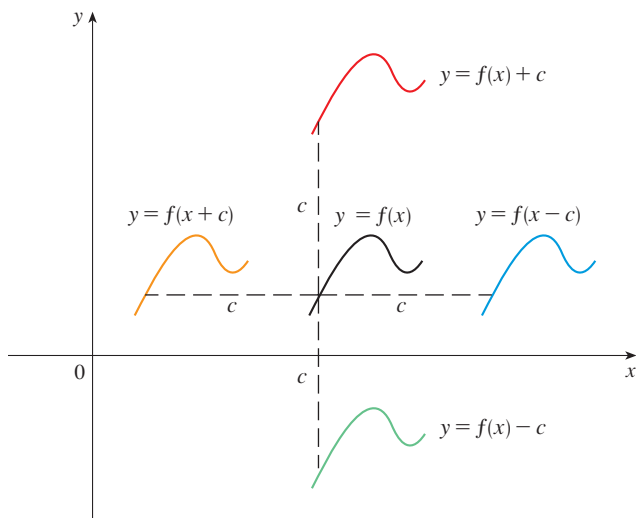
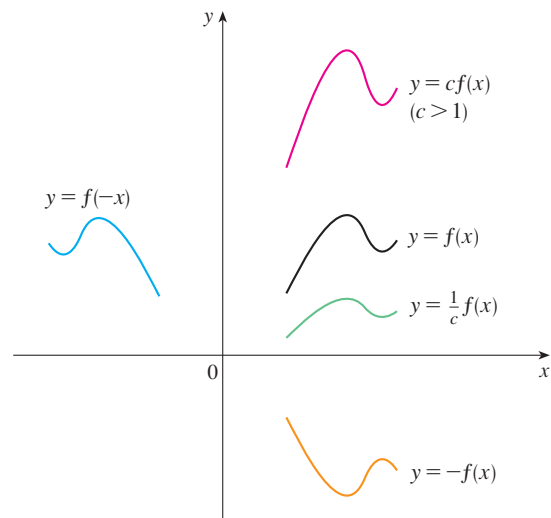
■ Transformations of Functions

By applying certain transformations to the graph of a given function we can obtain the graphs of related functions. This will give us the ability to sketch the graphs of many functions quickly by hand. It will also enable us to write equations for given graphs.

Let’s first consider **translations**. If c is a positive number, then the graph of $y = f(x) + c$ is just the graph of $y = f(x)$ shifted upward a distance of c units (because each y -coordinate is increased by the same number c). Likewise, if $g(x) = f(x - c)$, where $c > 0$, then the value of g at x is the same as the value of f at $x - c$ (c units to the left of x). Therefore the graph of $y = f(x - c)$ is just the graph of $y = f(x)$ shifted c units to the right (see Figure 1).

Vertical and Horizontal Shifts Suppose $c > 0$. To obtain the graph of

- $y = f(x) + c$, shift the graph of $y = f(x)$ a distance c units upward
- $y = f(x) - c$, shift the graph of $y = f(x)$ a distance c units downward
- $y = f(x - c)$, shift the graph of $y = f(x)$ a distance c units to the right
- $y = f(x + c)$, shift the graph of $y = f(x)$ a distance c units to the left

FIGURE 1 Translating the graph of f FIGURE 2 Stretching and reflecting the graph of f

Now let's consider the **stretching** and **reflecting** transformations. If $c > 1$, then the graph of $y = cf(x)$ is the graph of $y = f(x)$ stretched by a factor of c in the vertical direction (because each y -coordinate is multiplied by the same number c). The graph of $y = -f(x)$ is the graph of $y = f(x)$ reflected about the x -axis because the point (x, y) is replaced by the point $(x, -y)$. (See Figure 2 and the following chart, where the results of other stretching, shrinking, and reflecting transformations are also given.)

Vertical and Horizontal Stretching and Reflecting Suppose $c > 1$. To obtain the graph of

- $y = cf(x)$, stretch the graph of $y = f(x)$ vertically by a factor of c
- $y = (1/c)f(x)$, shrink the graph of $y = f(x)$ vertically by a factor of c
- $y = f(cx)$, shrink the graph of $y = f(x)$ horizontally by a factor of c
- $y = f(x/c)$, stretch the graph of $y = f(x)$ horizontally by a factor of c
- $y = -f(x)$, reflect the graph of $y = f(x)$ about the x -axis
- $y = f(-x)$, reflect the graph of $y = f(x)$ about the y -axis

Figure 3 illustrates these stretching transformations when applied to the cosine function with $c = 2$. For instance, in order to get the graph of $y = 2 \cos x$ we multiply the y -coordinate of each point on the graph of $y = \cos x$ by 2. This means that the graph of $y = \cos x$ gets stretched vertically by a factor of 2.

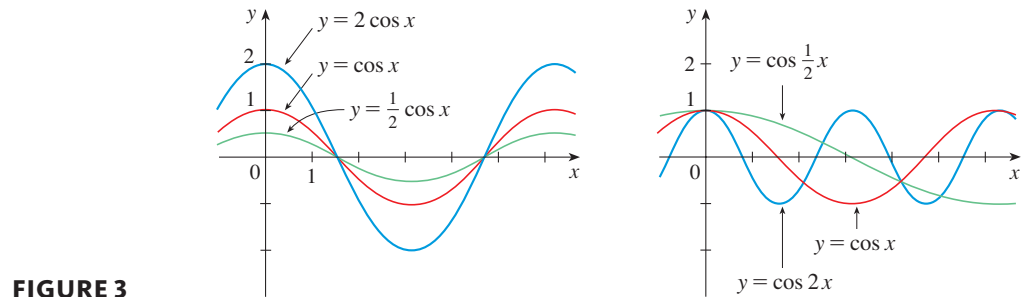


FIGURE 3

EXAMPLE 1 | Given the graph of $y = \sqrt{x}$, use transformations to graph $y = \sqrt{x} - 2$, $y = \sqrt{x - 2}$, $y = -\sqrt{x}$, $y = 2\sqrt{x}$, and $y = \sqrt{-x}$.

SOLUTION The graph of the square root function $y = \sqrt{x}$, obtained from Figure 1.2.13(a), is shown in Figure 4(a). In the other parts of the figure we sketch $y = \sqrt{x} - 2$ by shifting 2 units downward, $y = \sqrt{x - 2}$ by shifting 2 units to the right, $y = -\sqrt{x}$ by reflecting about the x -axis, $y = 2\sqrt{x}$ by stretching vertically by a factor of 2, and $y = \sqrt{-x}$ by reflecting about the y -axis.

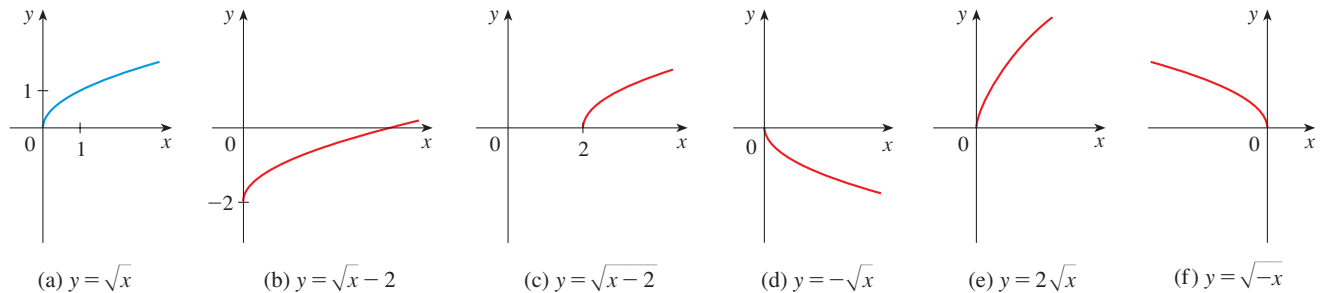


FIGURE 4

EXAMPLE 2 | Sketch the graph of the function $f(x) = x^2 + 6x + 10$.

SOLUTION Completing the square, we write the equation of the graph as

$$y = x^2 + 6x + 10 = (x + 3)^2 + 1$$

This means we obtain the desired graph by starting with the parabola $y = x^2$ and shifting 3 units to the left and then 1 unit upward (see Figure 5).

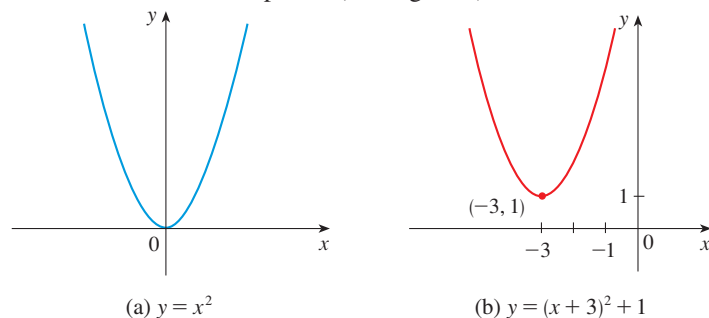


FIGURE 5

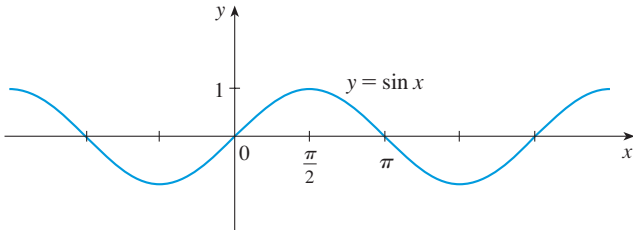
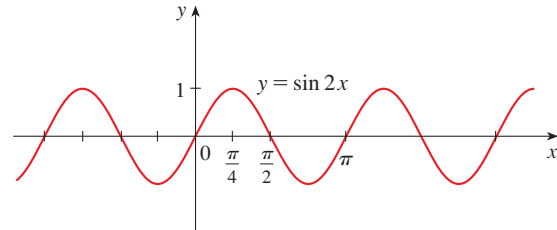
EXAMPLE 3 | Sketch the graphs of the following functions.

(a) $y = \sin 2x$

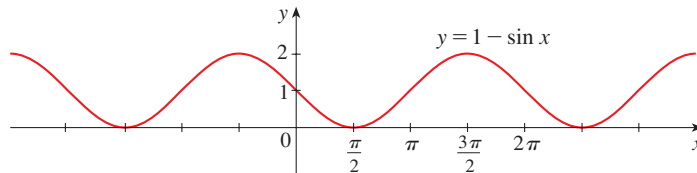
(b) $y = 1 - \sin x$

SOLUTION

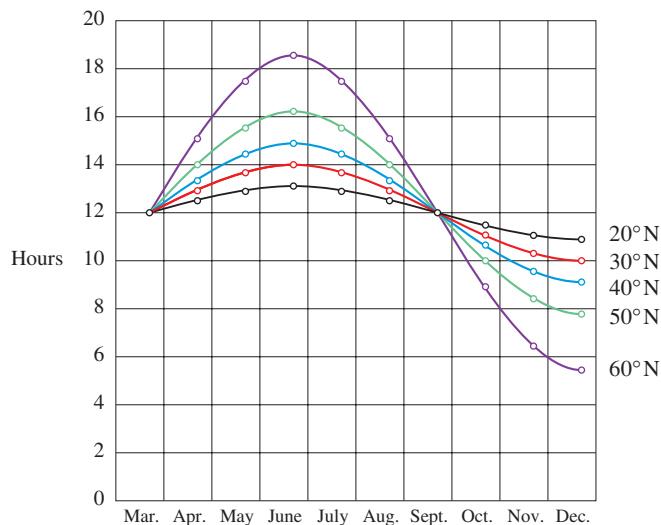
(a) We obtain the graph of $y = \sin 2x$ from that of $y = \sin x$ by compressing horizontally by a factor of 2. (See Figures 6 and 7.) Thus, whereas the period of $y = \sin x$ is 2π , the period of $y = \sin 2x$ is $2\pi/2 = \pi$.

**FIGURE 6****FIGURE 7**

(b) To obtain the graph of $y = 1 - \sin x$, we again start with $y = \sin x$. We reflect about the x -axis to get the graph of $y = -\sin x$ and then we shift 1 unit upward to get $y = 1 - \sin x$. (See Figure 8.)

**FIGURE 8**

EXAMPLE 4 | **Hours of daylight** Figure 9 shows graphs of the number of hours of daylight as functions of the time of the year at several latitudes. Given that Philadelphia is located at approximately 40°N latitude, find a function that models the length of daylight at Philadelphia.

**FIGURE 9**

Graph of the length of daylight from March 21 through December 21 at various latitudes

Source: Adapted from L. Harrison, *Daylight, Twilight, Darkness and Time* (New York: Silver, Burdett, 1935), 40.

SOLUTION Notice that each curve resembles a shifted and stretched sine function. By looking at the blue curve we see that, at the latitude of Philadelphia, daylight lasts about 14.8 hours on June 21 and 9.2 hours on December 21, so the amplitude of the curve (the factor by which we have to stretch the sine curve vertically) is $\frac{1}{2}(14.8 - 9.2) = 2.8$.

By what factor do we need to stretch the sine curve horizontally if we measure the time t in days? Because there are about 365 days in a year, the period of our model should be 365. But the period of $y = \sin t$ is 2π , so the horizontal stretching factor is $2\pi/365$.

We also notice that the curve begins its cycle on March 21, the 80th day of the year, so we have to shift the curve 80 units to the right. In addition, we shift it 12 units upward. Therefore we model the length of daylight in Philadelphia on the t th day of the year by the function

$$L(t) = 12 + 2.8 \sin \left[\frac{2\pi}{365}(t - 80) \right]$$

Combinations of Functions

Two functions f and g can be combined to form new functions $f + g$, $f - g$, fg , and f/g in a manner similar to the way we add, subtract, multiply, and divide real numbers. The sum and difference functions are defined by

$$(f + g)(x) = f(x) + g(x) \quad (f - g)(x) = f(x) - g(x)$$

If the domain of f is A and the domain of g is B , then the domain of $f + g$ is the intersection $A \cap B$ because both $f(x)$ and $g(x)$ have to be defined. For example, the domain of $f(x) = \sqrt{x}$ is $A = [0, \infty)$ and the domain of $g(x) = \sqrt{2 - x}$ is $B = (-\infty, 2]$, so the domain of $(f + g)(x) = \sqrt{x} + \sqrt{2 - x}$ is $A \cap B = [0, 2]$.

Similarly, the product and quotient functions are defined by

$$(fg)(x) = f(x)g(x) \quad \left(\frac{f}{g}\right)(x) = \frac{f(x)}{g(x)}$$

The domain of fg is $A \cap B$, but we can't divide by 0 and so the domain of f/g is $\{x \in A \cap B \mid g(x) \neq 0\}$. For instance, if $f(x) = x^2$ and $g(x) = x - 1$, then the domain of the rational function $(f/g)(x) = x^2/(x - 1)$ is $\{x \mid x \neq 1\}$, or $(-\infty, 1) \cup (1, \infty)$.

There is another way of combining two functions to obtain a new function. For example, suppose that $y = f(u) = \sqrt{u}$ and $u = g(x) = x^2 + 1$. Since y is a function of u and u is, in turn, a function of x , it follows that y is ultimately a function of x . We compute this by substitution:

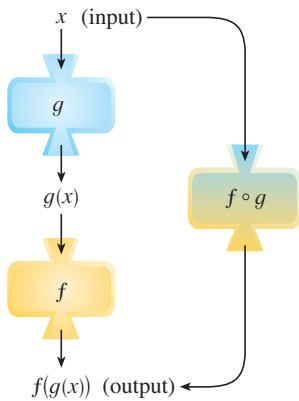
$$y = f(u) = f(g(x)) = f(x^2 + 1) = \sqrt{x^2 + 1}$$

The procedure is called *composition* because the new function is *composed* of the two given functions f and g .

In general, given any two functions f and g , we start with a number x in the domain of g and calculate $g(x)$. If this number $g(x)$ is in the domain of f , then we can calculate the value of $f(g(x))$. Notice that the output of one function is used as the input to the next function. The result is a new function $h(x) = f(g(x))$ obtained by substituting g into f . It is called the *composition* (or *composite*) of f and g and is denoted by $f \circ g$ (“ f circle g ”).

Definition Given two functions f and g , the **composite function** $f \circ g$ (also called the **composition** of f and g) is defined by

$$(f \circ g)(x) = f(g(x))$$

**FIGURE 10**

The $f \circ g$ machine is composed of the g machine (first) and then the f machine.

The domain of $f \circ g$ is the set of all x in the domain of g such that $g(x)$ is in the domain of f . In other words, $(f \circ g)(x)$ is defined whenever both $g(x)$ and $f(g(x))$ are defined. Figure 10 shows how to picture $f \circ g$ in terms of machines.

EXAMPLE 5 | If $f(x) = x^2$ and $g(x) = x - 3$, find the composite functions $f \circ g$ and $g \circ f$.

SOLUTION We have

$$(f \circ g)(x) = f(g(x)) = f(x - 3) = (x - 3)^2$$

$$(g \circ f)(x) = g(f(x)) = g(x^2) = x^2 - 3$$



NOTE You can see from Example 5 that, in general, $f \circ g \neq g \circ f$. Remember, the notation $f \circ g$ means that the function g is applied first and then f is applied second. In Example 5, $f \circ g$ is the function that *first* subtracts 3 and *then* squares; $g \circ f$ is the function that *first* squares and *then* subtracts 3.

EXAMPLE 6 | If $f(x) = \sqrt{x}$ and $g(x) = \sqrt{2 - x}$, find each function and its domain.
 (a) $f \circ g$ (b) $g \circ f$ (c) $f \circ f$ (d) $g \circ g$

SOLUTION

$$(a) \quad (f \circ g)(x) = f(g(x)) = f(\sqrt{2 - x}) = \sqrt{\sqrt{2 - x}} = \sqrt[4]{2 - x}$$

The domain of $f \circ g$ is $\{x \mid 2 - x \geq 0\} = \{x \mid x \leq 2\} = (-\infty, 2]$.

$$(b) \quad (g \circ f)(x) = g(f(x)) = g(\sqrt{x}) = \sqrt{2 - \sqrt{x}}$$

For $\sqrt{x}$ to be defined we must have $x \geq 0$. For $\sqrt{2 - \sqrt{x}}$ to be defined we must have $2 - \sqrt{x} \geq 0$, that is, $\sqrt{x} \leq 2$, or $x \leq 4$. Thus we have $0 \leq x \leq 4$, so the domain of $g \circ f$ is the closed interval $[0, 4]$.

$$(c) \quad (f \circ f)(x) = f(f(x)) = f(\sqrt{x}) = \sqrt{\sqrt{x}} = \sqrt[4]{x}$$

The domain of $f \circ f$ is $[0, \infty)$.

$$(d) \quad (g \circ g)(x) = g(g(x)) = g(\sqrt{2 - x}) = \sqrt{2 - \sqrt{2 - x}}$$

This expression is defined when both $2 - x \geq 0$ and $2 - \sqrt{2 - x} \geq 0$. The first inequality means $x \leq 2$, and the second is equivalent to $\sqrt{2 - x} \leq 2$, or $2 - x \leq 4$, or $x \geq -2$. Thus $-2 \leq x \leq 2$, so the domain of $g \circ g$ is the closed interval $[-2, 2]$.

It is possible to take the composition of three or more functions. For instance, the composite function $f \circ g \circ h$ is found by first applying h , then g , and then f as follows:

$$(f \circ g \circ h)(x) = f(g(h(x)))$$

EXAMPLE 7 | **BB** **Antibiotic dosage** Antibiotics are used to treat bacterial sinus infections. If a dosage of x mg is taken orally, suppose that the amount absorbed into the bloodstream through the stomach is $h(x) = 8x/(x + 8)$ mg. If x mg enters the bloodstream, suppose that the amount surviving filtration by the liver is $g(x) = \frac{1}{4}x$. Finally, if x mg survives filtration by the liver, suppose that $f(x) = x - 1$ mg is absorbed into the sinus cavity, provided that $x > 1$ [otherwise $f(x) = 0$].

If $0 \leq a \leq b$, then $a^2 \leq b^2$.

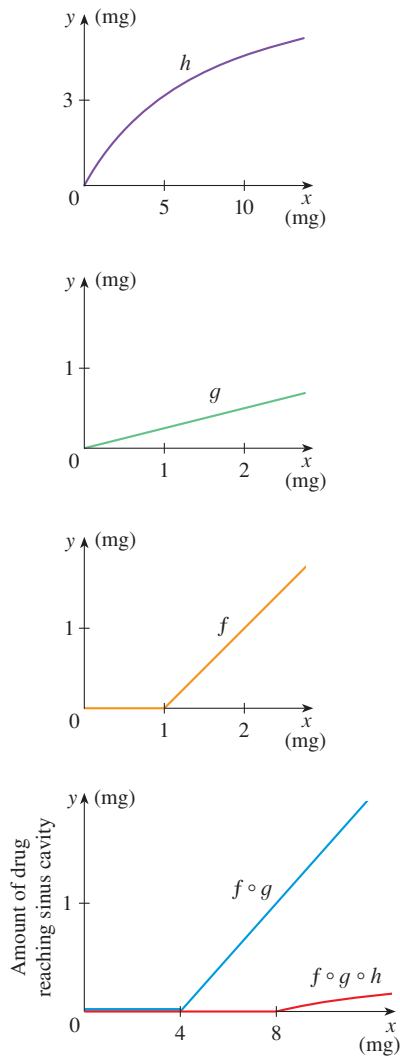


FIGURE 11

- (a) Use composition of functions to derive the function that relates oral dosage to the amount of drug that reaches the sinus cavity.
 (b) Suppose the antibiotic is instead administered by injection. Derive the function that relates dosage to the amount of drug that reaches the sinus cavity.

SOLUTION

- (a) The amount of antibiotic after filtration by the liver is

$$g(h(x)) = \frac{1}{4}h(x) = \frac{1}{4}\left(\frac{8x}{x+8}\right) = \frac{2x}{x+8}$$

$$\text{Now } \frac{2x}{x+8} > 1 \iff 2x > x+8 \iff x > 8$$

So if $x > 8$, the amount of the drug that reaches the sinus cavity is

$$f(g(h(x))) = f\left(\frac{2x}{x+8}\right) = \frac{2x}{x+8} - 1 = \frac{2x - (x+8)}{x+8} = \frac{x-8}{x+8}$$

Otherwise $f(g(h(x))) = 0$. So we can write the amount that reaches the sinus cavity as

$$f(g(h(x))) = \begin{cases} \frac{x-8}{x+8} & \text{if } x > 8 \\ 0 & \text{if } x \leq 8 \end{cases}$$

- (b) If the drug is administered by injection, then the amount reaching the sinus cavity is

$$f(g(x)) = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{4}x - 1 & \text{if } x > 4 \\ 0 & \text{if } x \leq 4 \end{cases}$$

Figure 11 displays the graphs of the functions f , g , and h , as well as the composite functions showing how the amount of antibiotic reaching the sinus cavity depends on the amount administered in both cases.

So far we have used composition to build complicated functions from simpler ones. But in calculus it is often useful to be able to *decompose* a complicated function into simpler ones, as in the following example.

EXAMPLE 8 | Given $F(x) = \cos^2(x+9)$, find functions f , g , and h such that $F = f \circ g \circ h$.

SOLUTION Since $F(x) = [\cos(x+9)]^2$, the formula for F says: First add 9, then take the cosine of the result, and finally square. So we let

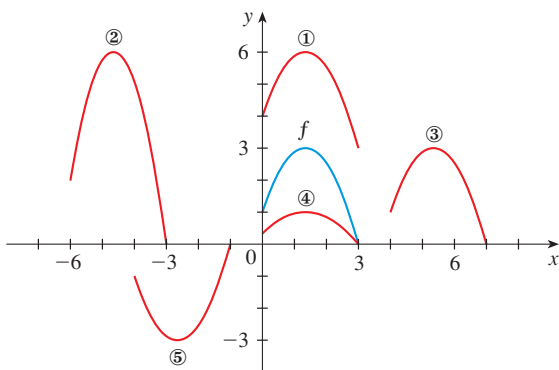
$$h(x) = x + 9 \quad g(x) = \cos x \quad f(x) = x^2$$

Then

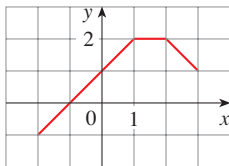
$$\begin{aligned} (f \circ g \circ h)(x) &= f(g(h(x))) = f(g(x+9)) = f(\cos(x+9)) \\ &= [\cos(x+9)]^2 = F(x) \end{aligned}$$

EXERCISES 1.3

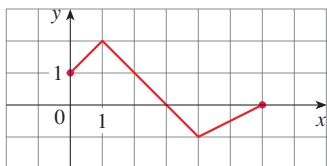
- Suppose the graph of f is given. Write equations for the graphs that are obtained from the graph of f as follows.
 - Shift 3 units upward.
 - Shift 3 units downward.
 - Shift 3 units to the right.
 - Shift 3 units to the left.
 - Reflect about the x -axis.
 - Reflect about the y -axis.
 - Stretch vertically by a factor of 3.
 - Shrink vertically by a factor of 3.
- Explain how each graph is obtained from the graph of $y = f(x)$.
 - $y = f(x) + 8$
 - $y = f(x + 8)$
 - $y = 8f(x)$
 - $y = f(8x)$
 - $y = -f(x) - 1$
 - $y = 8f\left(\frac{1}{8}x\right)$
- The graph of $y = f(x)$ is given. Match each equation with its graph and give reasons for your choices.
 - $y = f(x - 4)$
 - $y = f(x) + 3$
 - $y = \frac{1}{3}f(x)$
 - $y = -f(x + 4)$
 - $y = 2f(x + 6)$



- The graph of f is given. Draw the graphs of the following functions.
 - $y = f(x) - 2$
 - $y = f(x - 2)$
 - $y = -2f(x)$
 - $y = f\left(\frac{1}{3}x\right) + 1$



- The graph of f is given. Use it to graph the following functions.
 - $y = f(2x)$
 - $y = f\left(\frac{1}{2}x\right)$
 - $y = f(-x)$
 - $y = -f(-x)$



- How is the graph of $y = 2 \sin x$ related to the graph of $y = \sin x$? Use your answer and Figure 6 to sketch the graph of $y = 2 \sin x$.
 - How is the graph of $y = 1 + \sqrt{x}$ related to the graph of $y = \sqrt{x}$? Use your answer and Figure 4(a) to sketch the graph of $y = 1 + \sqrt{x}$.

7–20 Graph the function by hand, not by plotting points, but by starting with the graph of one of the standard functions given in Section 1.2, and then applying the appropriate transformations.

- $y = \frac{1}{x+2}$
- $y = (x-1)^3$
- $y = -\sqrt[3]{x}$
- $y = x^2 + 6x + 4$
- $y = \sqrt{x-2} - 1$
- $y = 4 \sin 3x$
- $y = \sin\left(\frac{1}{2}x\right)$
- $y = \frac{2}{x} - 2$
- $y = -x^3$
- $y = 1 - 2\sqrt{x+3}$
- $y = \frac{1}{2}(1 - \cos x)$
- $y = |x| - 2$
- $y = 1 - 2x - x^2$
- $y = \frac{1}{4} \tan\left(x - \frac{\pi}{4}\right)$

- The city of New Orleans is located at latitude 30°N . Use Figure 9 to find a function that models the number of hours of daylight at New Orleans as a function of the time of year. To check the accuracy of your model, use the fact that on March 31 the sun rises at 5:51 AM and sets at 6:18 PM in New Orleans.
- A variable star is one whose brightness alternately increases and decreases. For the most visible variable star, Delta Cephei, the time between periods of maximum brightness is 5.4 days, the average brightness (or magnitude) of the star is 4.0, and its brightness varies by ± 0.35 magnitude. Find a function that models the brightness of Delta Cephei as a function of time.
- Some of the highest tides in the world occur in the Bay of Fundy on the Atlantic Coast of Canada. At Hopewell Cape the water depth at low tide is about 2.0 m and at high tide it is about 12.0 m. The natural period of oscillation is about 12 hours and on June 30, 2009, high tide occurred at 6:45 AM. Find a function involving the cosine function that models the water depth $D(t)$ (in meters) as a function of time t (in hours after midnight) on that day.
- Volume of air in lungs** In a normal respiratory cycle the volume of air that moves into and out of the lungs is about 500 mL. The reserve and residual volumes of air that remain in the lungs occupy about 2000 mL and a single

respiratory cycle for an average human takes about 4 seconds. Find a model for the total volume of air $V(t)$ in the lungs as a function of time.

- 25. Gene frequency** The frequency of a certain gene in a parasite population undergoes sinusoidal cycles as a result of coevolution with its host. It reaches a maximum frequency of 80% and a minimum of 20%, with a complete cycle taking three years. Find a function that describes the gene frequency dynamics over time (measured in years) assuming that it starts at a frequency of 50% at time $t = 0$. See also Case Study 2 on page xlvii.

- 26. Cyclic neutropenia** is a blood disorder in humans characterized by periodic fluctuations in the density of a certain kind of blood cell called *neutrophils*. The density of neutrophils reaches highs of around 2000 cells/ μL of blood and lows near zero. The period of fluctuations is approximately three weeks. Model the temporal dynamics of neutrophils in days, assuming that the density is at its highest on day 0.

27–28 Find (a) $f + g$, (b) $f - g$, (c) fg , and (d) f/g and state their domains.

27. $f(x) = x^3 + 2x^2$, $g(x) = 3x^2 - 1$

28. $f(x) = \sqrt{3 - x}$, $g(x) = \sqrt{x^2 - 1}$

29–34 Find the functions (a) $f \circ g$, (b) $g \circ f$, (c) $f \circ f$, and (d) $g \circ g$ and their domains.

29. $f(x) = x^2 - 1$, $g(x) = 2x + 1$

30. $f(x) = x - 2$, $g(x) = x^2 + 3x + 4$

31. $f(x) = 1 - 3x$, $g(x) = \cos x$

32. $f(x) = \sqrt{x}$, $g(x) = \sqrt[3]{1 - x}$

33. $f(x) = x + \frac{1}{x}$, $g(x) = \frac{x + 1}{x + 2}$

34. $f(x) = \frac{x}{1 + x}$, $g(x) = \sin 2x$

35–38 Find $f \circ g \circ h$.

35. $f(x) = 3x - 2$, $g(x) = \sin x$, $h(x) = x^2$

36. $f(x) = |x - 4|$, $g(x) = 2^x$, $h(x) = \sqrt{x}$

37. $f(x) = \sqrt{x - 3}$, $g(x) = x^2$, $h(x) = x^3 + 2$

38. $f(x) = \tan x$, $g(x) = \frac{x}{x - 1}$, $h(x) = \sqrt[3]{x}$

39–44 Express the function in the form $f \circ g$.

39. $F(x) = (2x + x^2)^4$

40. $F(x) = \cos^2 x$

41. $F(x) = \frac{\sqrt[3]{x}}{1 + \sqrt[3]{x}}$

42. $G(x) = \sqrt[3]{\frac{x}{1 + x}}$

43. $v(t) = \sec(t^2) \tan(t^2)$

44. $u(t) = \frac{\tan t}{1 + \tan t}$

45–47 Express the function in the form $f \circ g \circ h$.

45. $R(x) = \sqrt{\sqrt{x} - 1}$

46. $H(x) = \sqrt[5]{2 + |x|}$

47. $H(x) = \sec^4(\sqrt{x})$

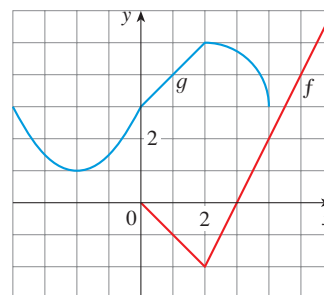
48. Use the table to evaluate each expression.

- (a) $f(g(1))$ (b) $g(f(1))$ (c) $f(f(1))$
(d) $g(g(1))$ (e) $(g \circ f)(3)$ (f) $(f \circ g)(6)$

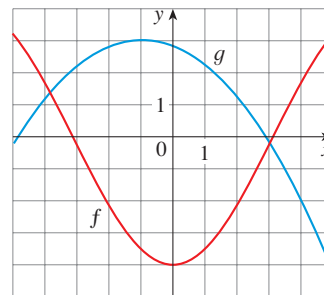
x	1	2	3	4	5	6
$f(x)$	3	1	4	2	2	5
$g(x)$	6	3	2	1	2	3

49. Use the given graphs of f and g to evaluate each expression, or explain why it is undefined.

- (a) $f(g(2))$ (b) $g(f(0))$ (c) $(f \circ g)(0)$
(d) $(g \circ f)(6)$ (e) $(g \circ g)(-2)$ (f) $(f \circ f)(4)$



50. Use the given graphs of f and g to estimate the value of $f(g(x))$ for $x = -5, -4, -3, \dots, 5$. Use these estimates to sketch a rough graph of $f \circ g$.



51. A stone is dropped into a lake, creating a circular ripple that travels outward at a speed of 60 cm/s.

- (a) Express the radius r of this circle as a function of the time t (in seconds).
(b) If A is the area of this circle as a function of the radius, find $A \circ r$ and interpret it.

52. A spherical balloon is being inflated and the radius of the balloon is increasing at a rate of 2 cm/s.
- Express the radius r of the balloon as a function of the time t (in seconds).
 - If V is the volume of the balloon as a function of the radius, find $V \circ r$ and interpret it.
53. A ship is moving at a speed of 30 km/h parallel to a straight shoreline. The ship is 6 km from shore and it passes a lighthouse at noon.
- Express the distance s between the lighthouse and the ship as a function of d , the distance the ship has traveled since noon; that is, find f so that $s = f(d)$.
 - Express d as a function of t , the time elapsed since noon; that is, find g so that $d = g(t)$.
 - Find $f \circ g$. What does this function represent?
54. **Bioavailability** is a term that refers to the fraction of an antibiotic dose taken orally that is absorbed into the bloodstream. Suppose that, for a dosage of x mg, the bioavailability is $h(x) = \frac{1}{2}x$ mg. If x mg enters the bloodstream, suppose that the amount eventually absorbed into the site of an infection is given by $g(x) = 4x/(x + 4)$ mg. Finally, if x mg is absorbed into the site of an infection, suppose that the number of surviving bacteria is given by $f(x) = 3200/(8 + x^2)$, measured in colony forming units, CFU.
- Derive the function that relates dosage to the number of surviving bacteria using composition of functions.
 - Suppose the antibiotic is instead administered by injection. Derive the function that relates dosage to the number of surviving bacteria using composition of functions.
 - Sketch the graphs of the functions found in parts (a) and (b).
55. **Matrix-digesting enzymes** are sometimes produced by cancer cells to digest the tissue surrounding the tumor, allowing it to grow and spread. In solid tumors, the enzymes are produced only by the cells on the surface of the tumor. Suppose the diameter of a spherical tumor is growing at a rate of g mm/year.
- What is the diameter d of the tumor as a function of time?
 - Suppose the rate of enzyme production P is proportional to the surface area of the tumor S . Find $P \circ S \circ d$ and interpret it.
56. If you invest x dollars at 4% interest compounded annually, then the amount $A(x)$ of the investment after one year is $A(x) = 1.04x$. Find $A \circ A$, $A \circ A \circ A$, and $A \circ A \circ A \circ A$. What do these compositions represent? Find a formula for the composition of n copies of A .
57. Let f and g be linear functions with equations $f(x) = m_1x + b_1$ and $g(x) = m_2x + b_2$. Is $f \circ g$ also a linear function? If so, what is the slope of its graph?
58. Suppose g is an even function and let $h = f \circ g$. Is h always an even function?
59. Suppose g is an odd function and let $h = f \circ g$. Is h always an odd function? What if f is odd? What if f is even?

PROJECT The Biomechanics of Human Movement

BB



Periodic processes in biology often display much more complicated patterns than those of the sine and cosine functions. For example, the vertical force exerted on the ground during human locomotion can display a variety of patterns depending on speed. (See, for example, Figure 1.) One way to model such processes is to first construct a function that adequately models a single cycle and then to use a periodic extension of this function to represent multiple cycles. In this project you will transform the cosine function to model the vertical force exerted on the ground during running and walking using such periodic extensions.

- Consider the force exerted on the ground during one stride of the right leg during running at 3.6 m/s [Figure 1(a)]. Suppose the foot strikes the ground at $t = 0$, leaves the ground at $t = 0.25$ s, and that the maximal force exerted on the ground is 2 kN. Explain why the function $f(t) = 1 - \cos(8\pi t)$ provides a reasonable description of the force exerted over one stride.
 - Plot the periodic extension of the function from part (a) assuming it repeats every 0.65 seconds.
- To model the force pattern of a single cycle during walking at 1.5 m/s [Figure 1(b)] we need to alter the function from Problem 1(a) so that it is wider.

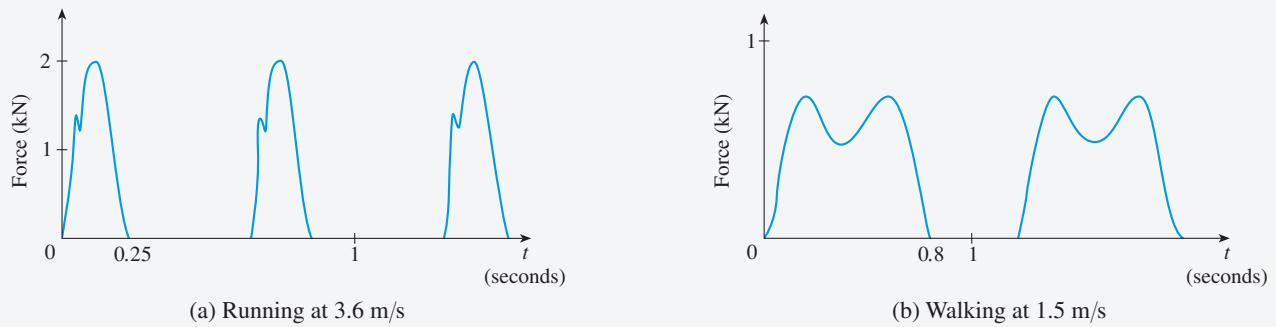


FIGURE 1

Source: Adapted from R. Alexander, “Walking and Running,” *American Scientist* 72 (1984): 348–54.

Do so, assuming that the foot strikes the ground at $t = 0$ and leaves the ground at $t = 0.8$ s.

- 
 (b) The function in part (a) has the correct width but we need to create a dip in the function midway through the stride at $t = 0.4$ s. One way to do this is to add the function in part (a) to a similar function that oscillates twice as fast (that is, has half the period) and then scale the height of the resulting function appropriately. Use this approach to obtain a function with the desired shape.


 (c) Plot the periodic extension of the function obtained in part (b) assuming it repeats every 1.2 seconds.


3. A variation of the function in Problem 2(b) is given by

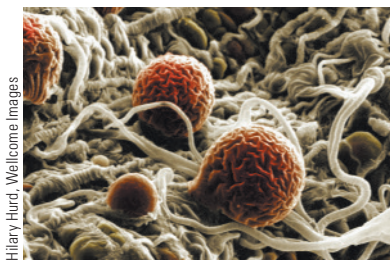
$$g(t) = 1 - \frac{\cos(2.5\pi t) + q \cos(5\pi t)}{1 + q}$$

where q is a constant.

- (a) Plot the graph of g for $q = 0.2, 0.8$, and 1.8 . What role does q play?
- (b) Compare the graphs of g in part (a) with the graph of the function in Problem 2(b).

1.4 Exponential Functions

We often hear people saying that something is “growing exponentially.” What does that mean, exactly? We answer that question in this section by looking at examples of exponential growth and decay as modeled by exponential functions.



■ The Growth of Malarial Parasites

Malaria kills more than a million people every year. To understand the mechanisms that regulate malarial growth, controlled experiments have been done on mice. Individual cells of the malarial species *Plasmodium chabaudi* reproduce synchronously (at the same time) every 24 hours. The parasites develop in red blood cells for a period of 24 hours and then they all burst at the same time, quickly invade new blood cells, and start the process again. Each infected blood cell produces eight new parasites when it bursts. So a single parasite at time 0 produces 8 parasites after 1 day, $8 \times 8 = 64$ parasites after

2 days, and so on. If $P(n)$ is the number of parasites after n days, then

$$P(0) = 1$$

$$P(1) = 8$$

$$P(2) = 8 \times P(1) = 8^2$$

$$P(3) = 8 \times P(2) = 8^3$$

This pattern continues for six or seven days, so for that time period we have

$$P(n) = 8^n$$

The rapid growth of this function is demonstrated by the table of values and the resulting scatter plot in Figure 1.

Day n	$P(n)$
0	1
1	8
2	64
3	512
4	4,096
5	32,768

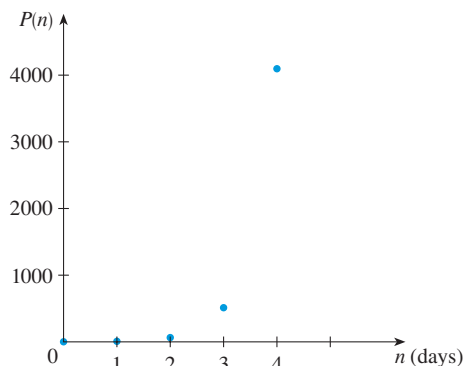


FIGURE 1

■ Exponential Functions

The function $P(n) = 8^n$ is called an *exponential function* because the variable n is the exponent. Likewise, $f(x) = 5^x$ is an exponential function because x is the exponent. The exponential function $f(x) = 2^x$ should not be confused with the power function $g(x) = x^2$, in which the variable is the base.

In general, an **exponential function** is a function of the form

$$f(x) = b^x$$

where b is a positive constant. Let's recall what this means.

If $x = n$, a positive integer, then

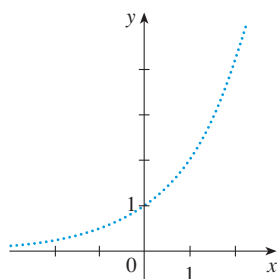
$$b^n = \underbrace{b \cdot b \cdot \dots \cdot b}_{n \text{ factors}}$$

If $x = 0$, then $b^0 = 1$, and if $x = -n$, where n is a positive integer, then

$$b^{-n} = \frac{1}{b^n}$$

If x is a rational number, $x = p/q$, where p and q are integers and $q > 0$, then

$$b^x = b^{p/q} = \sqrt[q]{b^p} = \left(\sqrt[q]{b}\right)^p$$


FIGURE 2

Representation of $y = 2^x$,
 x rational

But what is the meaning of b^x if x is an irrational number? For instance, what is meant by $2^{\sqrt{3}}$ or 5^π ?

To help us answer this question, we first look at the graph of the function $y = 2^x$, where x is rational. A representation of this graph is shown in Figure 2. We want to enlarge the domain of $y = 2^x$ to include both rational and irrational numbers.

There are holes in the graph in Figure 2 corresponding to irrational values of x . We want to fill in the holes by defining $f(x) = 2^x$, where $x \in \mathbb{R}$, so that f is an increasing function. In particular, since the irrational number $\sqrt{3}$ satisfies

$$1.7 < \sqrt{3} < 1.8$$

we must have

$$2^{1.7} < 2^{\sqrt{3}} < 2^{1.8}$$

and we know what $2^{1.7}$ and $2^{1.8}$ mean because 1.7 and 1.8 are rational numbers. Similarly, if we use better approximations for $\sqrt{3}$, we obtain better approximations for $2^{\sqrt{3}}$:

$$\begin{array}{llll} 1.73 < \sqrt{3} < 1.74 & \Rightarrow & 2^{1.73} < 2^{\sqrt{3}} < 2^{1.74} \\ 1.732 < \sqrt{3} < 1.733 & \Rightarrow & 2^{1.732} < 2^{\sqrt{3}} < 2^{1.733} \\ 1.7320 < \sqrt{3} < 1.7321 & \Rightarrow & 2^{1.7320} < 2^{\sqrt{3}} < 2^{1.7321} \\ 1.73205 < \sqrt{3} < 1.73206 & \Rightarrow & 2^{1.73205} < 2^{\sqrt{3}} < 2^{1.73206} \\ \vdots & & \vdots & \end{array}$$

A proof of this fact is given in
J. Marsden and A. Weinstein, *Calculus
Unlimited* (Menlo Park, CA: Benjamin/
Cummings, 1981).

It can be shown that there is exactly one number that is greater than all of the numbers

$$2^{1.7}, \quad 2^{1.73}, \quad 2^{1.732}, \quad 2^{1.7320}, \quad 2^{1.73205}, \quad \dots$$

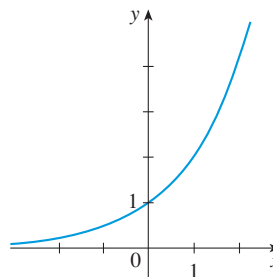
and less than all of the numbers

$$2^{1.8}, \quad 2^{1.74}, \quad 2^{1.733}, \quad 2^{1.7321}, \quad 2^{1.73206}, \quad \dots$$

We define $2^{\sqrt{3}}$ to be this number. Using the preceding approximation process, we can compute it correct to six decimal places:

$$2^{\sqrt{3}} \approx 3.321997$$

Similarly, we can define 2^x (or b^x , if $b > 0$) where x is any irrational number. Figure 3 shows how all the holes in Figure 2 have been filled to complete the graph of the function $f(x) = 2^x$, $x \in \mathbb{R}$.


FIGURE 3
 $y = 2^x$, x real

The graphs of members of the family of functions $y = b^x$ are shown in Figure 4 for various values of the base b . Notice that all of these graphs pass through the same point $(0, 1)$ because $b^0 = 1$ for $b \neq 0$. Notice also that as the base b gets larger, the exponential function grows more rapidly (for $x > 0$).

If $0 < b < 1$, then b^x approaches 0 as x becomes large. If $b > 1$, then b^x approaches 0 as x decreases through negative values. In both cases the x -axis is a horizontal asymptote. These matters are discussed in Section 2.2.

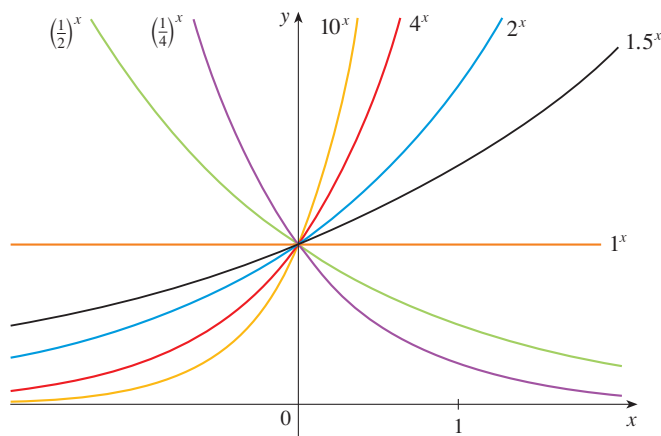


FIGURE 4

You can see from Figure 4 that there are basically three kinds of exponential functions $y = b^x$. If $0 < b < 1$, the exponential function decreases; if $b = 1$, it is a constant; and if $b > 1$, it increases. These three cases are illustrated in Figure 5. Observe that if $b \neq 1$, then the exponential function $y = b^x$ has domain $\mathbb{R}$ and range $(0, \infty)$. Notice also that, since $(1/b)^x = 1/b^x = b^{-x}$, the graph of $y = (1/b)^x$ is just the reflection of the graph of $y = b^x$ about the y -axis.

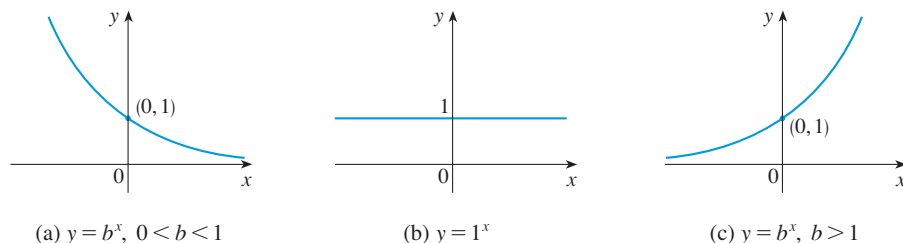


FIGURE 5

One reason for the importance of the exponential function lies in the following properties. If x and y are rational numbers, then these laws are well known from elementary algebra. It can be proved that they remain true for arbitrary real numbers x and y .

www.stewartcalculus.com
For review and practice using the
Laws of Exponents, click on *Review
of Algebra*.

Laws of Exponents If a and b are positive numbers and x and y are any real numbers, then

$$1. \ b^{x+y} = b^x b^y \quad 2. \ b^{x-y} = \frac{b^x}{b^y} \quad 3. \ (b^x)^y = b^{xy} \quad 4. \ (ab)^x = a^x b^x$$

EXAMPLE 1 | Sketch the graph of the function $y = 3 - 2^x$ and determine its domain and range.

For a review of reflecting and shifting graphs, see Section 1.3.

SOLUTION First we reflect the graph of $y = 2^x$ [shown in Figures 3 and 6(a)] about the x -axis to get the graph of $y = -2^x$ in Figure 6(b). Then we shift the graph of $y = -2^x$ upward 3 units to obtain the graph of $y = 3 - 2^x$ in Figure 6(c). The domain is $\mathbb{R}$ and the range is $(-\infty, 3)$.

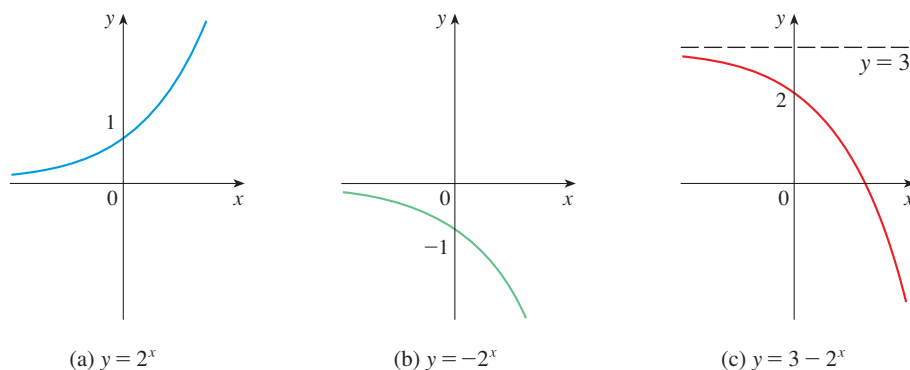


FIGURE 6

EXAMPLE 2 | Use a graphing device to compare the exponential function $f(x) = 2^x$ and the power function $g(x) = x^2$. Which function grows more quickly when x is large?

SOLUTION Figure 7 shows both functions graphed in the viewing rectangle $[-2, 6]$ by $[0, 40]$. We see that the graphs intersect three times, but for $x > 4$ the graph of $f(x) = 2^x$ stays above the graph of $g(x) = x^2$. Figure 8 gives a more global view and shows that for large values of x , the exponential function $y = 2^x$ grows far more rapidly than the power function $y = x^2$.

Example 2 shows that $y = 2^x$ increases more quickly than $y = x^2$. To demonstrate just how quickly $f(x) = 2^x$ increases, let's perform the following thought experiment. Suppose we start with a piece of paper a thousandth of an inch thick and we fold it in half 50 times. Each time we fold the paper in half, the thickness of the paper doubles, so the thickness of the resulting paper would be $2^{50}/1000$ inches. How thick do you think that is? It works out to be more than 17 million miles!

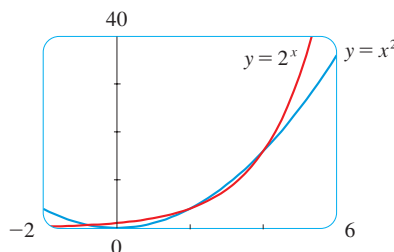


FIGURE 7

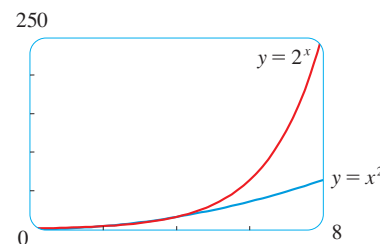


FIGURE 8

Exponential Growth

We have seen how the exponential function $P(n) = 8^n$ models the initial growth of the malarial parasite *P. chabaudi*. In the next example we use an exponential function to model the human population in the 20th century.

EXAMPLE 3 | **BB** **World population growth** Table 1 shows data for the population of the world from 1900 to 2010. Use an exponential function to model the data.

SOLUTION Figure 9 shows the scatter plot corresponding to the data in Table 1.

Table 1			
t (years after 1900)	Population (millions)	t (years after 1900)	Population (millions)
0	1650	60	3040
10	1750	70	3710
20	1860	80	4450
30	2070	90	5280
40	2300	100	6080
50	2560	110	6870

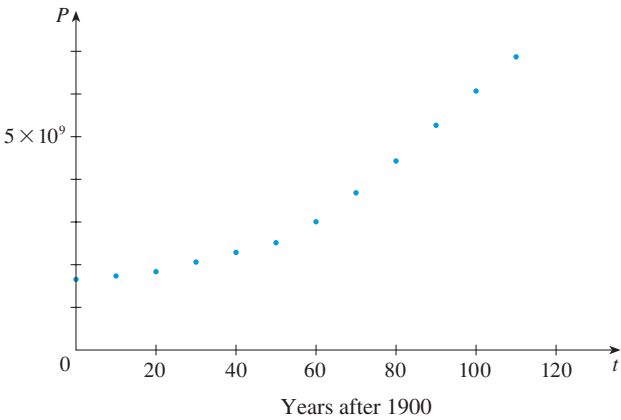


FIGURE 9 Scatter plot for world population

The pattern of the data points in Figure 9 suggests exponential growth, so we use a graphing calculator with exponential regression capability to apply the method of least squares and obtain the exponential model

$$P = (1436.53) \cdot (1.01395)^t$$

where $t = 0$ corresponds to 1900. Figure 10 shows the graph of this exponential function together with the original data points. We see that the exponential curve fits the data reasonably well. The period of relatively slow population growth is explained by the two world wars and the Great Depression of the 1930s.

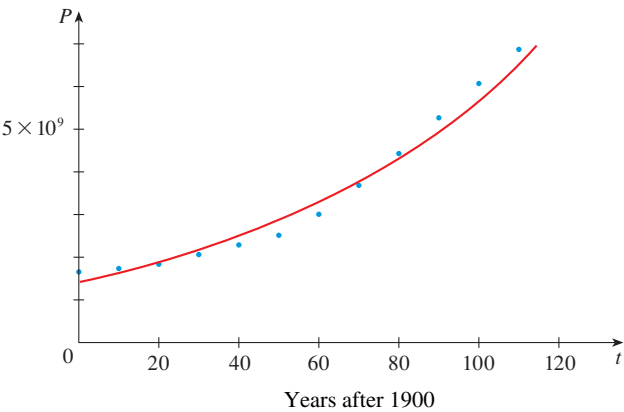
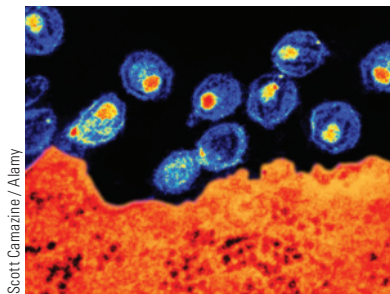


FIGURE 10
Exponential model for
population growth



HIV Density and Exponential Decay

In 1995 a paper appeared detailing the effect of the protease inhibitor ABT-538 on the human immunodeficiency virus HIV-1.¹ Table 2 shows values of the plasma viral load $V(t)$ of patient 303, measured in RNA copies per mL, t days after ABT-538 treatment was begun. The corresponding scatter plot is shown in Figure 11.

Table 2	
t (days)	$V(t)$
1	76.0
4	53.0
8	18.0
11	9.4
15	5.2
22	3.6

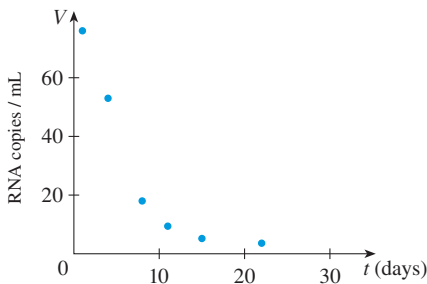


FIGURE 11 Plasma viral load in patient 303

The rather dramatic decline of the viral load that we see in Figure 11 reminds us of the graphs of the exponential function $y = b^x$ in Figures 4 and 5(a) for the case where the base b is less than 1. So let’s model the function $V(t)$ by an exponential function. Using a graphing calculator or computer to fit the data in Table 2 with an exponential function of the form $y = a \cdot b^t$, we obtain the model

$$V = 96.39785 \cdot (0.818656)^t$$

In Figure 12 we graph this exponential function with the data points and see that the model represents the viral load reasonably well for the first month of treatment.

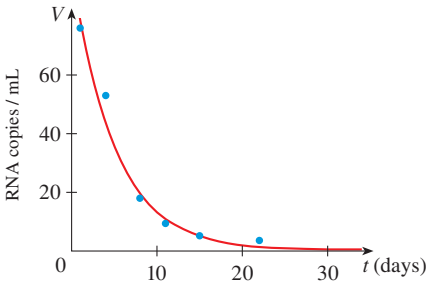


FIGURE 12 Exponential model for viral load

We could use the graph in Figure 12 to estimate the **half-life** of V , that is, the time required for the viral load to be reduced to half its initial value. (See Exercise 33.) In the next example we are given the half-life of a radioactive element and asked to find the mass of a sample at any time.

- EXAMPLE 4 | The half-life of strontium-90, ^{90}Sr , is 25 years. This means that half of any given quantity of ^{90}Sr will disintegrate in 25 years.
- (a) If a sample of ^{90}Sr has a mass of 24 mg, find an expression for the mass $m(t)$ that remains after t years.
- (b) Find the mass remaining after 40 years, correct to the nearest milligram.

1. D. Ho et al., “Rapid Turnover of Plasma Virions and CD4 Lymphocytes in HIV-1 Infection,” *Nature* 373 (1995): 123–26.

(c) Use a graphing device to graph $m(t)$ and use the graph to estimate the time required for the mass to be reduced to 5 mg.

SOLUTION

(a) The mass is initially 24 mg and is halved during each 25-year period, so

$$m(0) = 24$$

$$m(25) = \frac{1}{2}(24)$$

$$m(50) = \frac{1}{2} \cdot \frac{1}{2}(24) = \frac{1}{2^2}(24)$$

$$m(75) = \frac{1}{2} \cdot \frac{1}{2^2}(24) = \frac{1}{2^3}(24)$$

$$m(100) = \frac{1}{2} \cdot \frac{1}{2^3}(24) = \frac{1}{2^4}(24)$$

From this pattern, it appears that the mass remaining after t years is

$$m(t) = \frac{1}{2^{t/25}}(24) = 24 \cdot 2^{-t/25} = 24 \cdot (2^{-1/25})^t$$

This is an exponential function with base $b = 2^{-1/25} = 1/2^{1/25}$.

(b) The mass that remains after 40 years is

$$m(40) = 24 \cdot 2^{-40/25} \approx 7.9 \text{ mg}$$

(c) We use a graphing calculator or computer to graph the function $m(t) = 24 \cdot 2^{-t/25}$ in Figure 13. We also graph the line $m = 5$ and use the cursor to estimate that $m(t) = 5$ when $t \approx 57$. So the mass of the sample will be reduced to 5 mg after about 57 years.

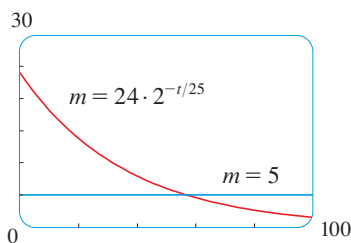


FIGURE 13

■ The Number e

Of all possible bases for an exponential function, there is one that is most convenient for the purposes of calculus. The choice of a base b is influenced by the way the graph of $y = b^x$ crosses the y -axis. Figures 14 and 15 show the tangent lines to the graphs of $y = 2^x$ and $y = 3^x$ at the point $(0, 1)$. (Tangent lines will be defined precisely in Section 3.1. For present purposes, you can think of the tangent line to an exponential graph at a point as the line that touches the graph only at that point.) If we measure the slopes of these tangent lines at $(0, 1)$, we find that $m \approx 0.7$ for $y = 2^x$ and $m \approx 1.1$ for $y = 3^x$.

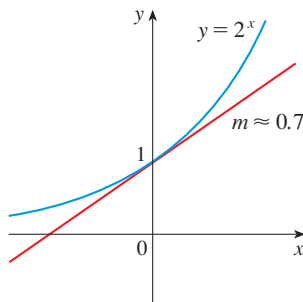


FIGURE 14

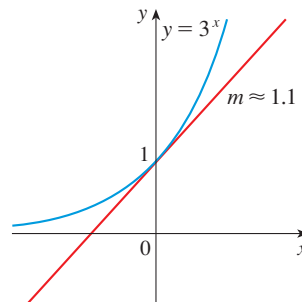


FIGURE 15

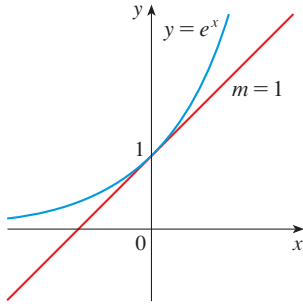


FIGURE 16
The natural exponential function crosses the y -axis with a slope of 1.

TEC Module 1.4 enables you to graph exponential functions with various bases and their tangent lines in order to estimate more closely the value of b for which the tangent has slope 1.

It turns out, as we will see in Chapter 3, that some of the formulas of calculus will be greatly simplified if we choose the base b so that the slope of the tangent line to $y = b^x$ at $(0, 1)$ is *exactly* 1. (See Figure 16.) In fact, there *is* such a number and it is denoted by the letter e . (This notation was chosen by the Swiss mathematician Leonhard Euler in 1727, probably because it is the first letter of the word *exponential*.) In view of Figures 14 and 15, it comes as no surprise that the number e lies between 2 and 3 and the graph of $y = e^x$ lies between the graphs of $y = 2^x$ and $y = 3^x$. (See Figure 17.) In Chapter 3 we will see that the value of e , correct to five decimal places, is

$$e \approx 2.71828$$

We call the function $f(x) = e^x$ the **natural exponential function**.

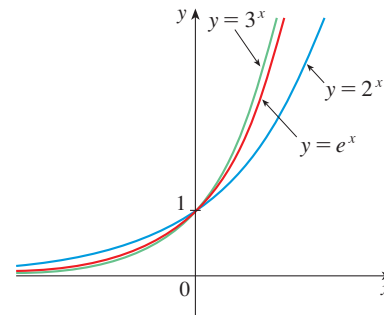


FIGURE 17

EXAMPLE 5 | Graph the function $y = \frac{1}{2}e^{-x} - 1$ and state the domain and range.

SOLUTION We start with the graph of $y = e^x$ from Figures 16 and 18(a) and reflect about the y -axis to get the graph of $y = e^{-x}$ in Figure 18(b). (Notice that the graph crosses the y -axis with a slope of -1 .) Then we compress the graph vertically by a factor of 2 to obtain the graph of $y = \frac{1}{2}e^{-x}$ in Figure 18(c). Finally, we shift the graph downward one unit to get the desired graph in Figure 18(d). The domain is $\mathbb{R}$ and the range is $(-1, \infty)$.

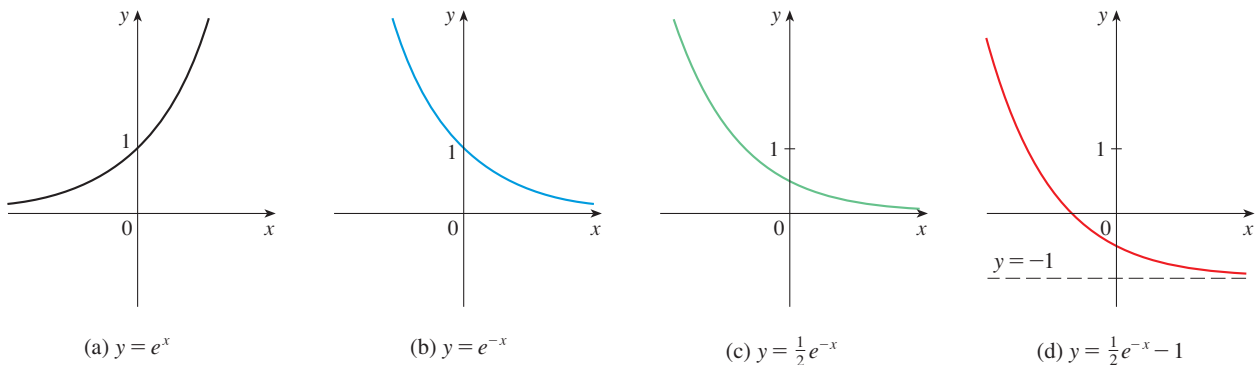


FIGURE 18

How far to the right do you think we would have to go for the height of the graph of $y = e^x$ to exceed a million? The next example demonstrates the rapid growth of this function by providing an answer that might surprise you.